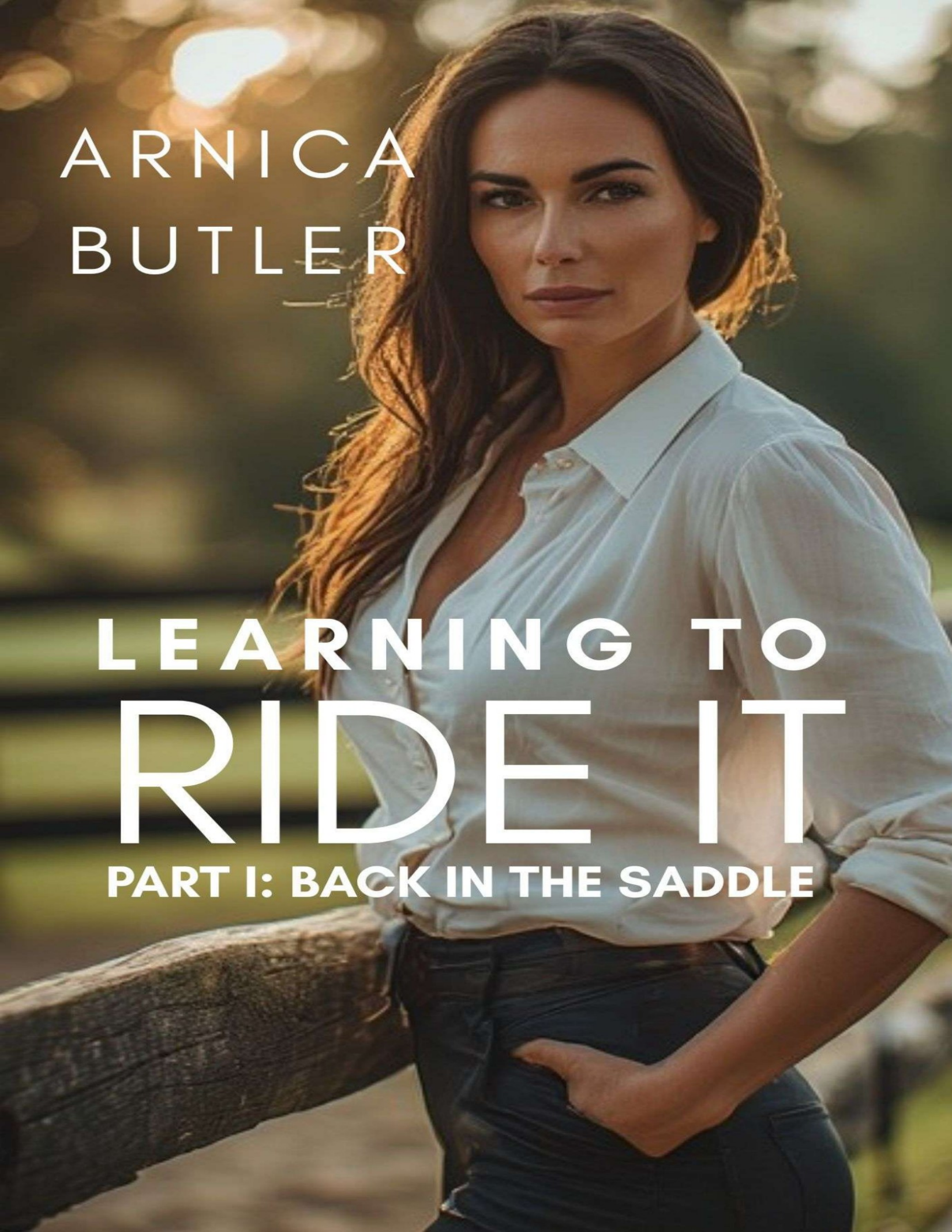
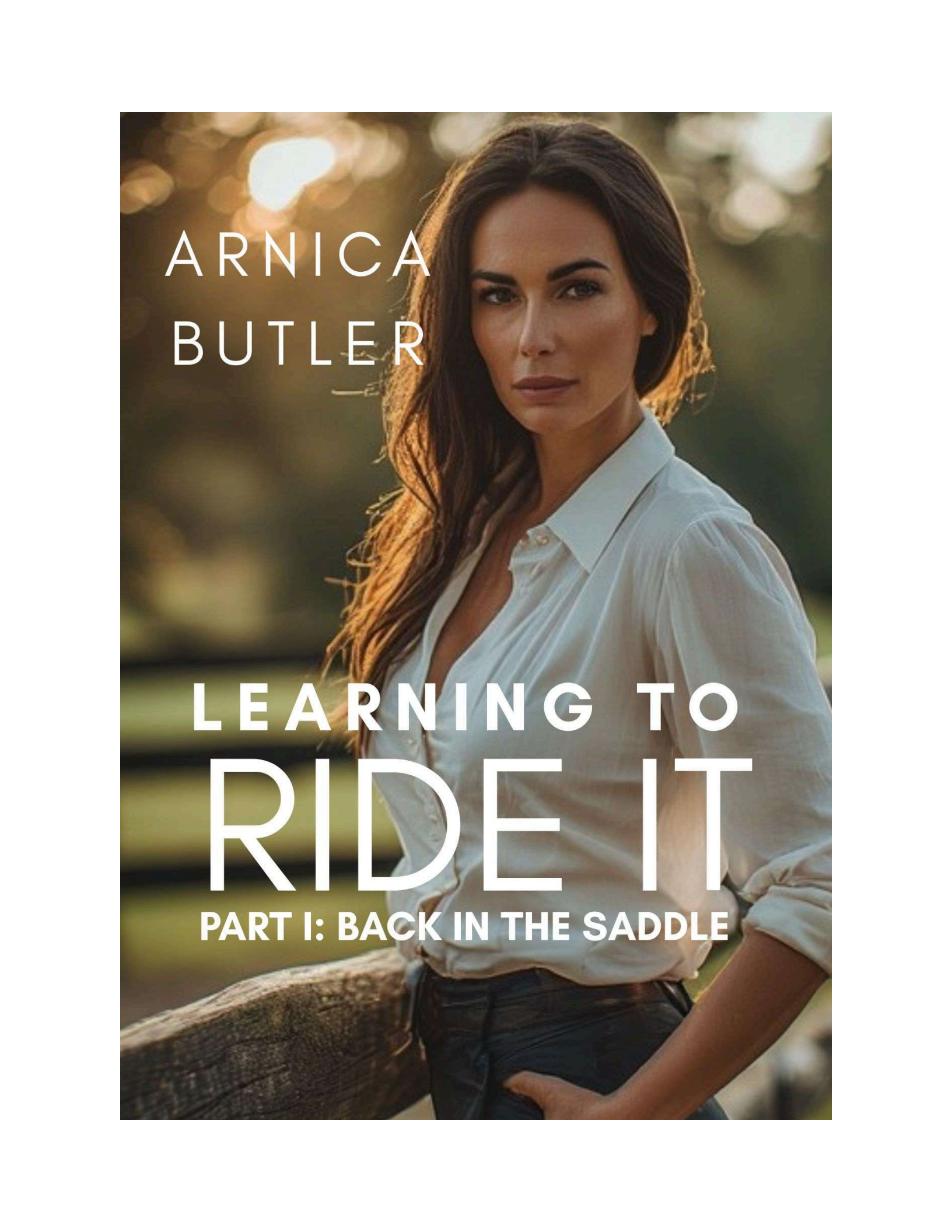




ARNICA
BUTLER

LEARNING TO RIDE IT

PART I: BACK IN THE SADDLE



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Chapter One

Gravel crunched under the tires as Phil pulled the car into the parking lot.

The place had been stunningly refurbished.

The barn that once sagged under peeling paint now stood square and true, its white boards gleaming in the afternoon sun. New fencing marched in straight lines across what Phil remembered as tangled pastures. Someone had poured serious money into this operation.

He stepped out of the car and breathed in the sharp December air. Even the gravel looked fresh, not the pitted mess it had been when he'd driven past last spring.

The barn's interior was dim after the brightness outside. He blinked, letting his eyes adjust. Horse smells hit him. Hay, manure, leather and that particular warmth animals gave off. A figure moved in one of the stalls at the far end.

"Hello?"

The mucking stopped. A black man straightened up from behind a wheelbarrow, setting down his pitchfork with deliberate care. He was tall,

well over six feet, with shoulders that filled out his work shirt. The muscles in his forearms stood out as he brushed off his hands.

He walked toward Phil without hurrying. Each step measured. His face gave nothing away.

"Can I help you?" he asked. His words carried the faintest trace of some African accent Phil couldn't quite place.

Phil offered his best friendly-neighbour smile. "Yeah, hi. I'm looking to set up some riding lessons. A Christmas present for my wife."

The man stopped a few feet away. Up close he was even bigger than Phil had first thought. Not fat, solid. The kind of build that came from hard work, not a gym.

"The office is around the corner." He gestured with his chin toward the far side of the barn. "They'll get you sorted."

"Great. Thanks."

The man turned and walked towards the back of the barn without another word.

Phil hesitated, then walked out. The guy probably dealt with random people wandering in all day. Still, something about the way he'd looked at Phil, or rather, the way he hadn't really looked at all, left an odd feeling in his gut.

He followed the barn's exterior wall around to where a smaller building jutted out. A hand-painted sign read "Office" above a green door. Through the window he could see a desk, filing cabinets, a calendar on the wall featuring a chestnut mare mid-jump.

Phil reached for the handle, then paused. The stable hand's face flashed through his mind again. That blank expression. The slow, purposeful walk.

He shook his head. Come on. The guy was just doing his job. Phil was reading into nothing.

The door opened before he could turn the handle. A woman in her forties stepped out, nearly colliding with him.

"Oh! Sorry, didn't see you there."

"My fault. I was just about to knock."

She had red hair pulled back in a ponytail and mud splattered across her boots. "Is there something I can help you with?" she asked.

Phil smiled at her. "Yeah, actually. I was wondering if you do riding lessons here?" he asked.

She tilted her head to one side, looking a little confused. "Uh, riding lessons for..." she asked as her eyes darted down his frame. "Yourself?"

Phil let out a soft chuckle. "Absolutely not," he replied. "For my wife, actually. She used to ride when she was younger."

"Perfect timing. Let me grab the schedule." She held the door open. "Come on in. I'm Susan, I run this place."

Phil followed her inside. The office smelled like coffee and paper. A space heater hummed in the corner.

Susan circled behind the desk and pulled out a binder. "We've got a few instructors. Depends on what level she's at, what she wants to work on."

"She hasn't been on a horse in probably twenty years. And I really have no idea about her ability," he replied.

"No problem. We'll start with basics, see how she feels." Susan flipped through pages covered in handwritten notes and schedules. "When were you thinking of starting?"

"So, it's actually supposed to be a Christmas present. Kind of a surprise, kind of thing," Phil explained.

"Ah!" Susan said. She shut the schedule. "Best thing for you would be our Ride-as-you-go plan. It's a package of ten lessons. She can just call a few days before and we can get her set up with an instructor. The plan never expires so she can take as long as she likes to use up the lessons. How does that sound?"

"That sounds perfect," he replied.

Susan pulled open a drawer and extracted a slim booklet with the farm's logo embossed on the cover. She clicked her pen and looked up.

"What's your wife's name?"

"Lydia."

Susan smiled as she wrote it down in careful script across the top line. "Oh, I love that name. So lyrical."

She filled in the rest of the information, asking Phil for a phone number and email address. Her pen scratched across the paper. When she finished, she swivelled to her computer and tapped at the keyboard. The printer whirred to life and spat out an invoice.

Phil glanced at the total and pulled out his credit card. The price was fair. More than fair, actually, considering how nice the place looked now.

Susan ran the card and handed him the booklet along with a receipt. "She's going to love it."

"I hope so." Phil tucked the booklet into his jacket pocket. "So who bought this place, anyway? Last time I drove past it looked ready to collapse. Now it's gorgeous."

"A gentleman named Obinna Okafor," Susan said. She stood and grabbed her jacket from the back of the chair. "He poured a fortune into renovating everything. New stalls, new arena, the whole works. I used to work here

when it was still Lazy Acres. When I saw them doing renovations I showed up and asked if they needed a farm manager."

"Okafor. That's Nigerian, right?" Phil asked.

"Yep. He's somewhere out on the grounds right now, actually." Susan headed for the door. "Would you like to meet him?"

Phil hesitated, then shrugged. "Sure, why not?"

Susan led him back outside and around the far side of the barn. She pointed out the new outdoor arena with its pristine white fencing and freshly harrowed sand. Beyond that sat a smaller building she identified as the tack room.

"We've got twelve horses now," she said as they walked. "Most of them rescues that Obi rehabilitated. He's good with them."

They passed a paddock where three horses stood nose to tail. Susan opened a gate and they cut across toward the main barn.

Susan walked straight down the centre aisle, boots ringing against concrete. She stopped at the same stall where Phil had first seen the man with the wheelbarrow.

"Obi?"

The man straightened up from checking a horse's hoof. He set the hoof down gently and turned.

Phil's stomach dropped.

"This is Phil Ackerman," Susan said. "He just bought a lesson package for his wife. Phil, this is Obinna. He owns Heavenly Hills."

Obinna wiped his hand on his jeans and extended it. "Good to meet you. Again"

Phil shook automatically. Obinna's grip was firm, his palm callused. "You too. I, uh..." Phil cleared his throat. "I'm sorry about earlier I thought you

were..."

"The stable hand?" Obinna's expression didn't change. "I get that sometimes."

Heat crept up Phil's neck. "I'm sorry. I didn't mean to assume."

"Nothing to apologize for." Obinna released his hand and stepped back. "I was mucking stalls. What else would you have assumed?"

Susan glanced between them. "Obi does everything around here. He doesn't, uh, believe in sitting in an office all day."

"The horses don't care about who you are," Obinna said. He patted the mare's neck. "They care if you show up."

Phil nodded, not trusting himself to say anything that wouldn't make things worse.

He fell into step beside Obinna as Susan waved and headed back toward the office. The afternoon sun slanted low across the paddocks, casting long shadows that stretched between the white fence posts.

Something about walking next to this man felt off-balance. Obinna moved with a kind of deliberate grace that seemed at odds with the rough work clothes and the smell of horse manure clinging to him. Phil had met plenty of wealthy guys, day trading put him in contact with all sorts, but they wore their money differently. Expensive watches, designer suits, that particular smugness that came with seven-figure portfolios.

Obinna wore work boots and had dirt under his fingernails.

Yet the way he carried himself, with an unhurried confidence, spoke of someone who had nothing to prove to anyone. It was magnetic in a way that made Phil's skin prickle.

"So your wife," Obinna said. His voice was low and measured. "She's ridden before?"

"Yeah, when she was younger. She stopped around college when things got busy." Phil shoved his hands in his pockets. "We had kids pretty young, and then her career took off. It's been at least twenty years."

"And now?"

"Now the kids are gone. Off at university. Lydia's got every other weekend free for the first time in, God, decades probably." Phil's car came into view as they stepped out of the barn. "I thought this might be something she'd enjoy getting back into."

Obinna nodded, his gaze fixed on some middle distance. "What sort of woman is she?"

Phil's step faltered. The question hung between them, feeling a bit too personal for a conversation with a stranger.

"What do you mean?"

"Your wife." Obinna glanced at him. Those dark eyes gave nothing away. "What is she like?"

"She's, uh, she's a heart surgeon." The words came out sounding almost defensive. Phil cleared his throat. "Cardiothoracic. She works crazy hours but she's brilliant at what she does."

"A surgeon." Obinna repeated the word like he was tasting it. "She must be very meticulous."

Phil stopped walking. They'd reached his car but he didn't pull out his keys. "Yeah. Yeah, she is." It was an odd remark but Phil chalked it up to cultural differences.

"Surgeons have to be." Obinna leaned against the fence post, one arm draped over the top rail. The posture was casual but something in his stillness felt calculated. "They control everything. Every incision, every stitch. Lives depend on their precision."

"Uh, yeah, that's Lydia." Phil forced a laugh that sounded a bit hollow. What a weird exchange.

Obinna's expression shifted, just barely. The corner of his mouth lifted. Not quite a smile.

"Interesting."

Phil pulled out his keys. The metal felt cold against his palm. "Well, I should get going. It was nice to meet you. Thanks for, uh, give Susan my thanks for showing me around."

Obinna nodded "Your wife will do well here." He pushed off the fence post. "I'll make sure of it."

Phil nodded and smiled before climbing into the car. He watched Obinna walk off towards the barn, then started the engine. He wondered how the eccentric man had come by his money as he reversed the car and then drove towards the road.

He shrugged off the question and had forgotten about the whole interaction ten minutes later.

Chapter Two

Two months later

Lydia pulled into a parking spot next to the outdoor arena in her white SUV and put it in park. There were three other cars in the parking lot, all of them high-end models. She let out a sigh as she cast her eyes towards the barn.

She closed her eyes and contemplated driving back home.

Phil, in his usual thoughtful, sweet way, had shocked her with this gift. She hadn't been in a saddle in over twenty years.

Somehow he'd gotten it into his head that she missed riding desperately, which she didn't. His expectant face when she'd opened the envelope with the little booklet had forced her hand.

She'd told him she loved the gift. That she couldn't wait to get back in the saddle and that he was so sweet for thinking of it.

She'd told herself that it wouldn't be too bad. Ten lessons at whatever pace she wanted to set. She'd get them done and over with, hopefully in time to catch a few Saturdays of fire place season in the armchair with the book she'd been meaning to read.

Phil had done this for her, now she was doing this for Phil.

Lydia tugged at the collar of her riding jacket as she stepped out of the SUV. The fitted tan fabric pulled across her chest in a way that hadn't happened two decades ago. Her breasts strained against the buttons, making the front gape slightly no matter how she adjusted it.

The breeches were worse. Beige and unforgiving, they clung to every curve of her hips and thighs. She hadn't had the time to go and shop for new ones, so she'd just squeezed into this old pair. The fabric stretched taut across her backside as she reached back into the car for her helmet.

Her feet already ached in the tall black boots. They'd taken ten minutes to zip up her calves, and the leather pressed against her skin like a vise.

She wished she'd gone and gotten sized and bought a fresh set of gear but that had just seemed like so much hassle.

A truck rumbled past on the road beyond the fence. Lydia caught the driver's head turn. Heat crept up her neck. She'd spent years in scrubs and professional suits, clothing designed to minimize and conceal. Riding gear did the opposite. It drew attention to legs and curves and the lines of her body.

She grabbed her helmet and crossed the lot with quick strides, suddenly aware of how her hips moved in the breeches.

The office sat adjacent to the barn, a small white building with an old wooden sign that read "Lazy Acres." Lydia pushed through the door into a cramped space dominated by a large desk covered in papers and horse magazines.

A middle aged woman, maybe a little younger than Lydia, looked up from a computer screen. "You must be Mrs. Ackerman."

"Lydia, please." She extended her hand.

"Susan." The handshake was brief and professional. Susan's gaze flicked over Lydia's outfit without comment, then returned to her screen. "You're right on time."

A silence stretched out between them. Susan typed something, then clicked her mouse.

"This is a beautiful property," Lydia said. "When was it renovated?"

"Mr. Okafor purchased it about eight years ago." Susan's fingers paused on the keyboard. "He's been working on it gradually since. Started with just the main barn and one pasture. Now we've got forty acres and two arenas."

"That's quite an expansion."

"Mr. Okafor has a passion for rescue horses." Susan's expression softened a fraction. "He travels all over looking for animals that need rehabilitation."

"That's admirable."

"He loves horses!" Susan stood and grabbed a set of keys from a hook on the wall. "Your instructor is Ellen. She's getting your horse ready now."

Lydia followed Susan out of the office and across a concrete walkway to the barn. The smell hit her with a wave of nostalgia. Hay and manure and leather, earthy and warm. Her boots echoed on the concrete aisle that ran between the stalls.

She hadn't exactly been loathing these lessons, but she hadn't been gleefully anticipating them, either. Now that she was in the barn memories drifted through her mind of simpler, happier times.

Maybe getting back in the saddle wasn't going to be so bad after all?

Horses poked their heads over stall doors, ears pricked forward. Some nickered softly.

"Ellen?" Susan called out.

"Back here," a voice answered from somewhere deeper in the barn.

Susan led Lydia past a tack room overflowing with saddles and bridles, past a wash rack with cross-ties hanging from the ceiling. At the far end of the aisle, a woman stood beside a chestnut horse, running a brush over its shoulder in long, smooth strokes.

The woman looked at her and smiled warmly. She stepped towards her and stretched her hand out. "Mrs. Ackerman?"

Lydia returned the smile. "Please, just Lydia." She shook her hand and immediately got a good feeling about Ellen.

Susan nodded to them both. "I'll leave you to it." Her footsteps receded down the aisle, fading into the background murmur of horses shifting in their stalls.

Ellen turned back to the chestnut. "Lydia, meet Butterscotch. He's been with us for about three years now. Mr. Okafor found him at an auction in Pennsylvania."

The horse turned his head toward Lydia, its dark eyes calm and curious.

She reached out and let him sniff her palm before stroking his neck. His coat was warm under her fingers.

"He's beautiful."

"And patient as a saint." Ellen resumed brushing. "I use him for all my beginner students. He could carry a toddler on his back and never put a foot wrong."

"How long has it been since you rode?" Ellen asked, moving to brush Butterscotch's other side.

"Twenty-three years." Lydia ran her hand down the horse's shoulder. "Not since college. My husband thought it would be a nice Christmas gift."

"Aw, that's sweet of him!" Ellen ducked under Butterscotch's neck and emerged with a saddle pad. "Did you want to come back to it?"

"I honestly hadn't thought about it in years." Lydia stepped back to give Ellen room. "But now that I'm here, it feels good. The barn, the smell, all of it. I'd forgotten how much I liked this."

"Let me grab his saddle. You can help if you'd like."

They worked together in an easy rhythm. Lydia's hands remembered the motions of getting the saddle on. The girth buckles, the way to thread the reins through the bit, the adjustment of the stirrups. Ellen talked her through each step without being condescending.

"Ready to head to the arena?" Ellen gathered the reins and led Butterscotch toward the barn entrance.

Lydia walked beside them. The sand in the indoor arena had been raked smooth. Mirrors lined one wall, reflecting the space back at them. Jump standards and poles sat stacked in a corner.

"Let me get the mounting block." Ellen started toward the far wall.

"I, uh, I think I can manage?" The words came out before Lydia could think them through. A strange ambition had gripped her. As if she suddenly had something prove to this woman.

She took the reins from Ellen and positioned Butterscotch. Her left hand gripped the pommel, her right the cantle. Left foot into the stirrup. She bounced once on her right leg and swung up.

The world shifted. She was higher than everything around her. Butterscotch stood steady beneath her. his breathing was even and calm. The leather creaked as she settled into the saddle. Her thighs gripped his sides, feeling the warmth of him. The power coiled in that massive body felt awesome.

Her hands found the reins and her fingers closed around them in a familiar grip. She could feel his mouth through the bit. It was all starting to come

back.

She'd forgotten this. The command of it, the partnership. The way the horse waited for her signal, responsive and ready. Her pulse quickened. A grin spread across her face before she could stop it.

"How does it feel?" Ellen asked from the ground.

"Amazing." Lydia straightened her shoulders. "Absolutely amazing."

Lydia squeezed her calves against Butterscotch's sides. The horse moved forward with a smooth, even gait. She posted in the saddle, rising and falling with his rhythm. Her hips remembered the motion without thought.

"Good," Ellen called. "Nice and easy."

Lydia urged Butterscotch into a trot. The faster pace made her thighs burn, muscles she hadn't used in decades suddenly engaged. But the discomfort faded as her body adjusted. She circled the arena, keeping the horse's head up, his stride consistent.

As she passed Ellen, the instructor clapped her hands together.

"I'm not going to have much work to do here!" Ellen's laughter echoed off the mirrors.

The sound made Lydia laugh too, a genuine burst of joy that surprised her. She pressed her heels down and leaned forward slightly. Butterscotch transitioned into a canter. His powerful hindquarters drove them forward. The three-beat gait rocked her in the saddle, smooth as silk.

She gave him more rein and he surged into a gallop.

Wind whipped past her face. The arena blurred at the edges of her vision. Butterscotch's mane flew back, tickling her hands. His muscles bunched and released beneath her, propelling them both forward.

Every worry about surgeries and schedules and the endless grind of her days dissolved. There was only this. The thunder of hooves, the heat of the

horse between her legs, the wild freedom of movement.

She slowed him gradually, bringing him back through the gaits until they stood in front of Ellen. Butterscotch's sides heaved. Lydia's own breathing came fast and hard.

"There's no need for lessons for you." Ellen grinned up at her. "Let me grab my own horse. Why don't we go out for a ride on the grounds instead?"

"Really?" The eagerness in her voice made her feel like a teenager again.

"Absolutely. Give me five minutes."

Lydia dismounted and walked Butterscotch in small circles to cool him down. Her legs trembled slightly as her feet hit the ground. The muscles in her inner thighs already ached in a way she'd forgotten.

Movement in the corner caught her eye.

A black man leaned against the arena wall, arms crossed over his chest. His broad shoulders filled out a white t-shirt that contrasted his dark skin. He stood completely still, watching her.

The intensity of his gaze it made her skin prickle. Most men who stared at her in the hospital did so with either reverence for her position or resentment at her authority. This was neither. This was appraisal. Assessment.

She'd dealt with men her entire career. Surgical residents who thought they knew better. Attending physicians who questioned her judgment in the OR. Hospital administrators who tried to talk over her in meetings. She'd learned early not to look away first.

Lydia led Butterscotch across the arena toward him. Her boots kicked up small clouds of sand. The horse followed placidly behind her.

The man didn't move as she approached. He didn't straighten or uncross his arms. His eyes tracked her progress with an unwavering focus.

She stopped a few feet away and met his stare directly.

"Can I help you with something?" she asked.

Chapter Three

"Perhaps," the man said, not looking away. The unforgiving stare was anti-social. Almost psychotic.

She felt her hackles come up at the man's boldness. "You stand there staring like that at all the students?" she challenged.

He blinked and furrowed his brow. "I was merely watching you ride?"

"Right," she replied. "You uh, you work here?" she asked, trying to gauge whether she'd misread him. He had an accent. Maybe this was some kind of cultural misunderstanding? It happened all the time at work.

"I do," he replied.

She nodded. She was still slightly unsettled by his behaviour. But now that she'd ascertained he wasn't as threatening as she'd first thought, she felt a certain...magnetism emanating from him.

"Can I ask where your accent is from?"

He nodded. "Of course. Nigeria."

Two thoughts connected in her mind and her stomach sank. "You're not..."

He stepped forward and extended a hand. "Obinna Okafor," he said.

She pressed two fingers to her temple, mortified at misreading his intentions. "You own the place?" she muttered.

"Yes."

She drew in a breath, collected herself and put on a smile as she took his hand. "I am *so* sorry," she said. "This is my first time back on a horse in over twenty years. I think I was feeling a little insecure and unsettled. When I saw you looking at me..."

"You certainly don't look either insecure or unsettled in that saddle Mrs..." He let the end of the sentence hang.

"Ackerman. Lydia Ackerman," she said. "Please just call me Lydia."

"You certainly don't look either insecure or unsettled in that saddle Mrs. Lydia Ackerman. Lydia."

She glanced down at his hand as he wrapped it around hers in a powerful grip.

His palm dwarfed hers, rough and warm, the grip firm enough to make her bones shift. The heat of his skin seemed to radiate up her arm, settling somewhere low in her belly. She felt small in his grasp. Not diminished necessarily, but contained.

The man radiated his presence the way Butterscotch had felt beneath her. A solid, muscular and controlled force of nature.

That same sense of power thrummed just beneath the surface of him, waiting to be unleashed. The comparison flickered through her mind and suddenly she wasn't thinking about the horse anymore.

The image formed in her mind and nearly made her gasp. Herself astride something other than a horse. Thighs clenching, hands gripping, that same exhilaration flooding through her veins as...

Heat flushed across her cheeks.

"I..." She fumbled for words and found none.

His eyes hadn't left hers. That dark and penetrating stare seemed to be reading every thought she desperately wanted to hide.

She yanked her hand back and looked away. Her pulse quickened.

"Obi!" Ellen's cheerful voice cut through the charged silence. She emerged from the barn leading a dappled grey mare. "I see you've met our superstar student."

"Indeed." His tone remained flat and unreadable.

Ellen beamed, oblivious. "Lydia's a natural. Haven't seen someone take to riding again that quickly in years." She patted the mare's neck. "This is Dumpling. She'll be perfect for the trail."

"Dumpling," Lydia repeated, grateful for something else to focus on. The name was ridiculously sweet.

"She's a rescue too," Ellen continued, running her hand along the horse's flank. "Came to us underweight and skittish. Look at her now."

The mare did look magnificent. Healthy coat, clear eyes, muscles rippling beneath the dappled grey.

"Obi has a gift for rehabilitation," Ellen said, glancing back at him with obvious admiration.

"I simply provide what they need," he replied.

Ellen gathered the lead rope. "Well, shall we head out? The weather won't hold forever."

Lydia moved to follow, eager to escape the oppressive weight of Obinna's presence.

"You are the wife of Phil?"

The question stopped her mid-step. She turned.

He stood exactly as before, hands loose at his sides, expression carved from stone. But something in his eyes had shifted.

"Yes." The word came out steady despite the flutter in her chest.

He nodded once,.

The air between them seemed to warm. The hairs on her arms stood on end. Her skin prickled with awareness, every nerve suddenly attuned to the man standing ten feet away.

Phil had mentioned purchasing the lessons here. Had he met Obinna? Spoken with him?

The thought unsettled her in a strange way.

"Come on, Lydia!" Ellen called from the barn entrance. "Dumpling's getting antsy."

She forced herself to move, to break whatever invisible thread connected her to this strange, intense man. As she walked away, she felt his gaze follow her.

Her hands trembled slightly and she gripped Butterscotch's reins tighter to hide it.

"You okay?" Ellen asked, concern creasing her features.

"Fine." Lydia manufactured a smile. "Just cold."

It wasn't cold. Her skin burned despite the February chill.

Phil heard a car pull into the driveway and craned his neck to look out the living room window.

It was Lydia.

He got up off the couch, pulled the drawstring on his sweatpants tighter and knotted it, then muted the football game he'd been watching on TV.

He crossed the large living room, walked through the open concept kitchen and to the front door.

Phil pressed his face close to the narrow window flanking the front door. Through the glass, he watched Lydia's silhouette remain motionless behind the steering wheel.

She wasn't getting out.

Her hands gripped the wheel at ten and two, shoulders rigid. Even from this distance, he recognized the posture. The same one she adopted in her office when reviewing complex surgical charts or contemplating a particularly difficult case.

His stomach tightened. The lesson had been a disaster. She'd hated every second. Worse, maybe she'd fallen off?

Christ, what had he been thinking? She hadn't ridden in, what, twenty years? He'd just assumed it would come back to her like riding a bike, but bikes didn't weigh twelve hundred pounds and have minds of their own.

He wiped his palms on his sweatpants.

Through the window, Lydia's head tilted down. Her fingers drummed against the leather. Whatever occupied her thoughts held her captive.

Phil stepped back from the glass, not wanting to be caught spying on his own wife in their own driveway. He shifted his weight from foot to foot, debating whether to go outside or wait.

Finally, the car door opened.

Lydia emerged wearing those ancient riding boots and faded breeches that had barely zipped up this morning. Her hair, usually pinned in a neat French

twist, hung loose around her shoulders. She closed the door with deliberate care and walked toward the house, her expression distant and unreadable.

Phil pulled the door open before she reached it.

"Hey! How'd it go?"

The transformation was instant. Her face lit up, creases smoothing from her forehead. She rushed forward and wrapped her arms around his neck, pressing herself against him with an enthusiasm that caught him off guard.

"Phil." Her voice came out breathless. "It was incredible."

Relief flooded through him. He returned the embrace, pulling her close, catching the scent of hay and horses and fresh air clinging to her clothes.

"Yeah?"

"It was amazing," she said.

He nodded, so thrilled that it hadn't been a total disaster. "The lesson went okay? You didn't fall off or anything?"

"Fall off? God, no." She laughed, the sound lighter than he'd heard in months. "Phil, I galloped. Me. I galloped a horse today. Ellen said I didn't even need lessons, that I should just come for trail rides instead."

"That's great, Lyd. Really great." He beamed at her.

"Butterscotch, that's the horse they gave me, he's a rescue. They're all rescues there. Mr. Okafor bought the whole property just to save them." She was talking faster now, animated in a way her surgical victories never quite produced. "It was like the last twenty-three years just vanished. My body remembered everything."

Phil studied her flushed cheeks, the way she couldn't quite stand still. "You look happy."

"I am happy." She kissed him again, softer this time. "This was the best Christmas gift anyone's ever given me. I couldn't have asked for anything

better."

"Good." He squeezed her hand. "I'm glad."

She stepped past him into the house, already pulling off her boots. "I need to shower. I smell like a barn."

"Little bit, yeah."

But as she headed for the stairs, Phil found himself thinking about that frozen moment in the car. About the concentration etched across her features, the white-knuckled grip on the wheel.

Whatever she'd been working through out there, it hadn't looked like happiness.

Phil walked to the kitchen and pulled open the oven door. Heat and the rich, sweet smell of slow-cooked pork billowed out.

The roast had been in since nine that morning, braising in apple cider vinegar and brown sugar. He grabbed the oven mitts from the counter and lifted the Dutch oven out, setting it on the stove top with a heavy thunk.

The meat fell apart when he prodded it with a fork. Perfect.

He transferred the pork to a cutting board and started shredding it with two forks, mixing it back with the cooking liquid. The tangy-sweet sauce coated each strand of meat.

From the pantry, he grabbed the bag of brioche buns Lydia had bought the day before. She always went for the fancy stuff. He sliced four of them open and arranged them on a plate, then pulled the coleslaw from the fridge, store-bought, but the good kind with the creamy dressing she preferred.

He set everything out on the kitchen table along with plates and napkins. The pork steaming in its serving dish. He stood back, surveying his work. Not bad for a guy whose wife did most of the cooking.

He grabbed two wine glasses from the cabinet, just in case, and set them by the sink.

Ten minutes later, Lydia appeared at the bottom of the stairs. She'd pulled on an oversized grey hoodie, his, actually, from their college days, and black sweatpants. Her damp hair hung in waves around her shoulders, darkened from the water. Her face, scrubbed clean of makeup, looked younger somehow.

"Hey." She smiled at him, padding barefoot across the hardwood. "How was your afternoon?"

"Just watched the game." Phil gestured at the table. "Bills lost in overtime. Brutal."

"Sorry to hear it." She moved to the table, leaning over the pork. "God, this smells amazing. When did you put this in?"

"This morning. Figured we'd need something good and filling after your big day."

Lydia straightened, tucking a strand of wet hair behind her ear. She paused, her fingers drumming against her thigh.

He recognized the same gesture he'd seen through the car window.

"Would it be okay if I had a glass of white with dinner? I know it's a Sunday, but..."

Phil was already reaching for the wine fridge before she finished. "Of course. Good idea, actually."

He pulled out the Pinot Grigio she liked, uncorked it, and filled both glasses. When he turned back, she'd already sat down at the table, pulling her plate closer.

"Here." He handed her a glass and settled into his own chair with the other.

Lydia took a sip, then set it down and started building her sandwich. Pork piled high on the brioche, a generous scoop of coleslaw on the side.

Phil did the same, watching her from the corner of his eye. The wine on a Sunday thing wasn't like her. Lydia lived by routines. Wine on Fridays, maybe Saturdays if they went out. Weeknights meant sparkling water or herbal tea.

But she looked relaxed. Content, even.

"This is really good, Phil." She took a bite, closing her eyes as she chewed. "Really, really good."

"Thanks." He grinned. "Low and slow does all the work."

She laughed softly and reached for her wine again. Her fingers wrapped around the stem, and she took another long sip before setting it down.

The late afternoon sun slanted through the kitchen window, casting everything in warm gold. Outside, a neighbour's dog barked. A car drove past.

Lydia ate her sandwich, and Phil ate his, and neither of them spoke for a while.

Phil stood and gathered the empty plates, stacking them carefully. Lydia moved to help, but he waved her off.

"Go relax on the couch. You've got to be up at five tomorrow, right?"

"Five-thirty," she corrected, but settled back in her chair. "You sure?"

"Yeah, go ahead. I got this."

She took her wine glass and padded into the living room.

Phil scraped the plates into the trash, then loaded them into the dishwasher along with the wine glasses and serving dishes. He wiped down the counter, put the leftover pork in a Tupperware container, and slid it into the fridge. The coleslaw went back on the shelf beside it.

With the kitchen looking good, he grabbed a bag of tortilla chips from the pantry and dumped some into a bowl, then pulled two cans of sparkling water from the fridge.

He carried everything into the living room.

Lydia had curled up in the corner of the couch, legs tucked beneath her, scrolling through the TV menu. The oversized hoodie had ridden up slightly, exposing a strip of her lower back above the sweatpants.

"Want to watch something?" Phil set the chips and drinks on the coffee table.

"Sure." She didn't look up from the screen. "Maybe a show. Something light that I don't have to think about too much."

"Works for me."

She scrolled past crime dramas and documentaries, finally stopping on some British baking competition. "This okay?"

"Yeah, fine."

Phil settled onto the couch beside her, close but not touching. The show started, bright kitchens, cheerful hosts, contestants nervously measuring flour.

He reached for the chips.

Something was different about Lydia tonight. Not bad different. Just different. The way she'd rushed to hug him when she got home. The wine with dinner.

Maybe it was just the riding. The endorphins or whatever from being active.

But there was something else too. A restlessness. Like she couldn't quite get comfortable in her own skin.

He wanted to ask her about it. Wanted to know what she'd been thinking about in the car, gripping the steering wheel like she was trying to hold onto something or let it go.

But he didn't want to pry. Didn't want to ruin whatever good mood the lesson had put her in.

On screen, a contestant's cake collapsed in the middle. The judges frowned sympathetically.

Lydia shifted beside him, uncurling her legs and stretching them out. Her foot brushed against his thigh.

"Sorry," she murmured.

"You're fine."

She settled deeper into the cushions, angling herself slightly toward him. Her hand fell gently onto his thigh.

Phil froze.

It wasn't high enough to be overtly sexual. But it was close. A little too close to his crotch to be casual. Too deliberate to be accidental.

Her fingers rested there, warm through the fabric of his sweatpants. She didn't move them. Didn't squeeze or stroke. Just left them there.

On screen, the hosts announced the next challenge. Contestants scrambled to their stations.

Phil's heart rate kicked up a notch. He kept his eyes on the TV, pretending to watch, but his mind stayed focused on that single point of contact.

Lydia's thumb moved. Just a fraction. A slow brush against the inside of his thigh.

He swallowed.

When he felt her head move to look up at him, he glanced down at her and smiled. "Everything okay?" he asked.

She nodded. "Everything's fine," she whispered.

He tensed as her hand moved an inch higher. Closer enough that if she moved her fingers the tips would brush against his cock.

He felt that warm tightness start to coalesce in his midriff at the possibility of intimacy.

Something really had gotten into her. Her initiating like this was highly unusual. If that's what she was doing.

Her fingers did move. They grazed against the outline of his cock and it gave a lazy throb at the gentle touch.

He looked down at her. "Hey," he said, smiling again. His smile faded to shock when she pulled his drawstring open, pulled the elastic of his sweatpants and underwear away from his stomach - and reached in.

Chapter Four

She pulled his cock out of his sweats and it sagged sideways towards her. Phil stared at her, astonished at the way *she* was staring at *it*.

He blinked as he watched her, his mouth slightly open. In twenty-three years of marriage, Lydia had never just grabbed him like this.

Their sex life remained good. Better than most couples their age, he'd wager. But it followed a pattern. Dinner out, maybe a cocktail or two, some lingering touches while they watched something on the couch. Then up to bed where they'd take their time, familiar and comfortable with each other's bodies.

This? This was totally unexpected. Not unwelcome at *all* but coming from way off the map.

Her fingers wrapped around him, her thumb sliding over the head and applying gentle but firm pressure. Her gaze fixed on his cock with an intensity that sent heat crawling up his neck. She looked fascinated, like she was seeing it for the first time.

She glanced up, caught his eye, and smiled. Not her usual warm smile, but something sharper and more playful. Almost mischievous.

Before he could say anything else, she lowered her face into his lap.

The wet heat of her mouth made him groan. His head tipped back against the couch as she took him deeper, her tongue moving in slow strokes along his shaft. Up, then down, dragging across the sensitive underside until he was fully hard.

Then she pulled off.

Phil looked down again, breathing hard. She'd wrapped her hand around him, stroking with that same methodical attention. Her eyes tracked the movement of her hand, studied the way his skin moved under her palm, the way he twitched when she squeezed.

Her grip tightened slightly and she twisted her wrist on the upstroke, a technique she normally saved for when they were already naked, already well into things. His hips jerked involuntarily.

"Jesus, Lyd," he whispered.

She hummed, seeming pleased with his reaction. Her other hand slid up his thigh, fingers digging into the muscle there.

His mind flashed back to her entrance earlier. To that strange tension in her shoulders when she'd first pulled into the driveway, followed by her sudden enthusiasm. The way she'd thrown herself into telling him about the lesson, about the horse, about how good it felt to ride again.

She'd seemed wound up then too. Restless.

Now that energy poured into her hand, into the steady rhythm she'd built. Her breathing deepened, and when she leaned forward to take him in her mouth again, she moaned around him.

She moaned.

Phil's fingers curled against the couch cushions. Lydia pulled back, let him slide almost completely out, then took him deep enough that he felt the

back of her throat. She'd never been particularly vocal during sex, preferring quiet sighs and the occasional gasp. But now she made soft sounds of satisfaction, like she was enjoying this as much as he was.

Her free hand moved to his balls, cupping them, rolling them gently while her mouth worked. The dual sensation had his toes curling, his breath coming in short bursts.

The pressure built in his balls. Slow heat spreading upwards into his belly. Each squeeze of Lydia's fingers sent another wave of heat through his groin, tightening everything from his thighs to his lower stomach. His cock throbbed in her hand, swollen and sensitive, and every stroke made the pressure better.

She worked him with both hands now, one wrapped around his shaft while the other cradled his balls, rolling them with careful pressure. Her thumb found the spot just behind them and pressed, kneading in small circles that made him gasp with pleasure.

He gripped the couch cushions harder. The pressure coiled tighter, gathering at the base of his spine. His balls drew up against his body, heavy and aching.

Lydia's face remained focused, her brow slightly furrowed. She looked like she did when she was performing surgery. Totally concentrated, hands steady and purposeful.

But this wasn't clinical. The flush in her cheeks, the way her lips parted slightly as she watched his cock flex and pulse in her grip, the intensity in her eyes, made him see she was aroused as well.

She squeezed harder, her strokes quickening. Her other hand cupped his balls more firmly, fingers pressing into the tender flesh between them and

his shaft. The pressure there pushed him closer to the edge, made everything tighten until he could barely breathe.

His hips started to move on their own, sending shallow thrusts into her fist. She matched his rhythm immediately, pumping faster. Her grip tightened on the upstroke, twisted at the top, then dragged back down with enough friction to make him grunt.

The pressure became unbearable. His balls felt full, too full, like they'd burst if he didn't come soon. Every stroke of her hand pulled another groan from his throat, every squeeze made his thighs shake.

Lydia leaned closer, her breath warm on his cock. She stared at it like she was willing it to explode, her hands working with single-minded determination. Not playful anymore. Not teasing. She wanted this. She wanted to see him blow.

His breathing turned ragged. The coil in his spine wound tighter, tighter, until it felt like a wire about to snap. His cock jerked in her hand, pre-cum leaking from the tip. She spread it with her thumb, used it to slicken her strokes, and the added wetness made everything more intense.

The pressure peaked. His balls pulled up so tight it almost hurt, every muscle in his body tensing as the orgasm built and built and...

Lydia looked up.

Her eyes locked onto his, dark and hungry, and her mouth curved into something that wasn't quite a smile.

"Shoot that dirty cum all over my face."

Phil's brain short-circuited. In twenty-three years, Lydia had never said anything like that. Never even hinted at it. She didn't talk during sex, certainly didn't say things like *dirty* or demand he come on her face.

But she stared at him now, waiting, her hands still pumping his cock with that same relentless rhythm. Her expression was fierce, almost challenging.

The words broke something loose inside him. The pressure exploded, pleasure ripping through his groin and up his spine. His cock pulsed once, hard, and then he was coming.

The first rope of cum shot across her cheek. She didn't flinch, didn't close her eyes. Just kept stroking him, kept staring, as another spurt hit her chin, then her forehead.

She stared deep into his eyes as his vision went fuzzy and he huffed and groaned and watched his semen splatter all over her pretty face.

He twitched on the couch and groaned again as he crested the peak of the climax, then started rolling down the other end.

Lydia's strokes slowed. Her grip loosened as she slid down to his root, then tightened as she pulled her hand back up, milking the last pearly drops of his ejaculate from him.

A rope of semen dangled from the tip of her nose.

Finally he had to put a hand over hers and still her pumping. His cock was too sensitive after the intense climax. He said nothing, just stared at her.

She turned her eyes towards his flagging appendage and that wild determination dissipated. She let go of his cock and pushed herself up to sit. "I think I'm going to take another shower," she said quietly.

Phil's jaw sagged. He watched her get up, holding one hand under the other so she didn't drip semen onto the floor.

She casually walked across the living room and disappeared up the stairs.

He sat there for a good few minutes before realizing his cock was still hanging out of his pants. He tucked it in, turned off the TV and turned out the lights before heading upstairs.

In the bedroom, he got undressed, tossing his clothes into the hamper. Then put on a fresh set of boxers and a white t-shirt before hopping into bed.

He scrolled his phone until Lydia walked in, patting a towel against the back of her neck.

She hung the towel on the little drying rack in the corner, pulled off the robe she was wearing to reveal her naked body.

His eyes widened. Another unusual immodesty from her.

She paraded in front of him to the dresser. She grabbed a pair of underwear and slid them up her legs, then pulled a spaghetti strap tank top on over her head and slipped into bed next to him.

He leaned on one elbow to face her.

She smiled, leaned towards him and kissed him on the lips.

"You, uh, you want me to return the favour?" he asked her.

She smiled again. "Early morning tomorrow. Maybe some other time," she said. She kissed him again, then rolled onto her side with her back towards him.

He sat there with his mind running in high gear.

To him it seemed only natural that, after an unexpected sexual event, a man would want to analyze what it was that triggered it.

Lydia had been annoyed countless times when he'd initiated that sort of post-coital analysis.

It tickled him now, though, the desire to ask her about it. Like, seriously, what the heck? She couldn't just pull a handjob like that on him with dirty talk about coming all over her face and expect him to not ask her where it had come from, could she?

Hell, *he'd* want to know where it had come from if it had been him that started it.

He drew in a breath and held it, choosing his words carefully before leaning towards her again.

"Phil, sweetheart, it was just one of those things," she muttered, her voice already a little sleepy. "It just kind of came out of nowhere and I thought I'd run with it. Was it fun?" she asked.

"Yes," he whispered.

"Perfect. Then let's just leave it at that? Can we?"

He held another breath for a moment. "Yes," he said. "Of course we can." He lay down on his back, reached up and turned out the bedside lamp.

Try as he might to 'leave it at that' his mind continued to whirl. After half an hour he'd gone back years trying to remember something that spontaneous had happened between them. Couldn't remember a single thing.

So, naturally, his whirring mind formed the most obvious question. What had been different about today than any day he could remember for the last few years.

The answer gave him a funny feeling somewhere between his balls and his bowels.

Horse lesson.

Chapter Five

Lydia was in the barn brushing Butterscotch when Ellen called out and waved from the far end. She smiled as the cheerful woman jogged towards her.

"Sorry I'm a few minutes late," Ellen said.

"No problem. I'm loving spending time with this guy," she said, patting the horse on the neck.

"He's such a cutey, isn't he?" Ellen asked.

Lydia pressed her cheek to his shoulder and closed her eyes.

She couldn't believe she hadn't thought of this sooner. Riding was the perfect stress relief. She'd been looking forward to getting back here all week.

The lessons had been a masterstroke of genius on Phil's part and she'd made a point of thanking him every chance she got.

They'd had a busy week and barely seen each other. But the times she did see him she could tell he was still ruminating over what had happened the previous Sunday after dinner.

It made her chuckle each time she thought about it. Phil was a successful day trader. He was a serious man that took life seriously. He'd been an amazing husband, father and provider.

But he was still a man and, like most other men she knew, he tended to get a little obsessed about sex.

She could tell he was turning that handjob over and over in his mind. Trying to figure out what triggered it. Probably trying to figure out how he could get a repeat.

It tickled her knowing he was still thinking about her in that way. That even after twenty-three years she could still capture his attention with her femininity.

She was certainly planning on giving him a repeat, but she was enjoying him puzzling about it, too.

"Everything okay?" Ellen asked, making Lydia realize she'd been lost in her thoughts for a while.

"Everything's fine," she said, chuckling. "I just feel so calm here it's easy to kind of drift away, you know?"

"I'm glad to hear that," Ellen replied. "I really enjoyed our ride last week."

"Can we do it again?" Lydia asked, an almost girlish excitement infecting her tone.

Ellen laughed. "Absolutely. Um, actually, though, there's something I was going to do a little differently this week."

"Oh?" Lydia asked, feeling a little disappointed. The ride the previous week had been so grounding and centering. Ellen was lovely company and the fresh air and being in the saddle had left her with a deep satisfaction. She kind of wanted to just do it all over again.

"So, actually, it's not really me. It's, uh, you remember Obinna from last week?" Ellen asked.

A flutter rippled through Lydia's chest at hearing his name. Her fingers paused mid-stroke along Butterscotch's mane.

"Of course," she said, keeping her voice level. "The owner."

"Right. Well, he wanted to know if you'd be interested in riding one of his personal horses today. Apollo. He's a beautiful gelding, really spirited but well-trained. Obinna thought you might enjoy the challenge."

Lydia's heart kicked against her ribs. She turned back to Butterscotch, resuming her brushing with slow strokes to hide the warmth creeping up her neck.

This was ridiculous. She was a forty-six-year-old married woman, a respected surgeon, and here she was getting flustered because some man she'd barely spoken to had thought of her.

"That sounds lovely," she managed.

The truth sat in her chest like a guilty secret. She'd been fighting thoughts of Obinna Okafor all week. That first couple of days, he'd intruded at the most inconvenient moments into her mind. During rounds, while reviewing surgical notes, in the middle of conversations with colleagues. She'd shake her head and refocus, annoyed at her own distraction.

By Wednesday, she'd stopped being annoyed and started being honest with herself. She had a crush. An absurd, juvenile crush on a man she'd exchanged maybe twenty words with.

It mortified her. She was better than this. More disciplined.

But discipline apparently didn't apply to the way her pulse quickened when she remembered how he'd looked at her. That dark, intense stare that seemed to see past her carefully constructed exterior. The way his hand had

engulfed hers, warm and rough-palmed. His sheer physical presence. Broad-shouldered and solid in a way that made her feel almost delicate by comparison.

She'd caught herself replaying that moment in the barn more times than she cared to admit. The weight of his gaze. The low rumble of his voice when he'd asked if she was Phil's wife.

Thursday night, while Phil was out with his friends, she'd run a bath. poured wine and let her mind wander where it wanted.

Her hand had slipped between her thighs almost without conscious thought, and she'd imagined those dark eyes watching her. Imagined what his hands might feel like. What his weight might feel like.

She'd come hard and fast, biting her lip to keep quiet even though the house was empty.

Afterwards, wrapped in her robe and feeling flushed and guilty, she'd told herself it was harmless. A fantasy. Everyone had them. It didn't mean anything.

"Lydia?"

She blinked, realizing Ellen was watching her with a slightly puzzled expression.

"Sorry, what?"

"I asked if you wanted to meet Apollo first, or just saddle up?"

"Let's meet him," Lydia said, setting down the brush. Her palms felt damp. She wiped them on her riding pants.

Ellen led her toward the far stalls, chatting about Apollo's temperament and training history. Lydia made appropriate noises of interest, but her mind raced.

Would Obinna be here today? Was that why he'd suggested his horse?

The thought both thrilled and terrified her. Indulging her little fantasy had been fun. She knew now that part of the reason she'd gone home and jerked Phil off so lewdly on the couch had something to do with what had happened here last Sunday.

She understood it had something to do with Obinna. She just wasn't sure exactly what. And now it seemed to be looming over her. Now it was time to confront whatever had fuelled that sexy evening on the couch.

She didn't trust her own reactions around him. Didn't trust that she could maintain the professional, composed demeanour that was her default setting.

This crush was harmless as long as it stayed in her head. As long as she could smile politely, ride the man's horse, and go home to her husband without making a fool of herself.

She told herself could do that. She'd spent her entire career maintaining composure under pressure.

This was no different.

Everything changed when they came to Apollo's stall and she saw Obinna bent over, cleaning out the horse's hoof.

The flutter started in Lydia's stomach the moment Obinna straightened, unfolding from his crouch with an easy grace that seemed impossible for a man his size. Apollo's hoof thudded softly against the stall floor as Obinna set it down.

His smile came slow, spreading across his mouth. It matched his gaze. Deep, dark and knowing.

"Mrs. Ackerman." His voice rolled over her with a warmth that had been absent the last time they spoke. "Good to see you again."

The flutter intensified, spreading outward from her core in ripples that left her fingertips tingling. She felt absurdly young, like a teenager faced with her first real crush. Heat bloomed in her cheeks.

"Mr. Okafor." She managed to keep her voice steady and professional. A surgeon's voice.

"Call me Obinna, please." He stepped closer, and she caught his scent. Straw and leather with just a hint of a masculine cologne beneath. It made her want to lean in closer to him. "We're not so formal here."

"Then you must call me Lydia," she said, smiling at him.

He held her stare as he nodded.

Ellen cleared her throat. The sound made Lydia jump slightly, reminded that they weren't alone despite how her entire focus had narrowed to the man in front of her.

"I'll just get Butterscotch ready," Ellen said, her tone carefully neutral. "Come find me when you're ready to ride, Lydia."

Then she was gone, footsteps retreating down the barn aisle, leaving Lydia acutely aware of the sudden quiet, the rustle of hay and Apollo's soft breathing.

Obinna's gaze traveled down her body. From her face to her throat to the fitted riding shirt that suddenly felt too tight across her breasts. Down to her hips, her thighs, the tall boots she wore.

Then back up, just as slowly.

Her nerve endings lit up under that visual caress. She felt exposed in a way that made her deeply unsettled and desperately excited all at once. Her skin prickled. Her breathing became shallow.

She should say something. Break the tension. Step back. Offer a pleasantry.

Instead she stood there, rooted, unable to look away from those dark eyes.

"I saw you riding last week," he said. His accent curled around the words, making them sound so intimate. "You have a good, strong stance in the saddle. Natural. But your lower back? You arch too much. Throws your balance forward."

"Oh." The syllable came out breathy. She hated how it sounded. She cleared her throat. "I hadn't noticed."

"I did." He tilted his head slightly, still studying her. "I have a riding machine. Mechanical horse. Very useful for correcting posture without the unpredictability of a live animal. I could help you with your form if you'd like?"

Lydia's mind, which had been relatively controlled up until this moment, took an abrupt detour straight into the gutter.

Riding machine. Correcting posture. Help you with your form.

Was there innuendo there? Or was she projecting her own increasingly inappropriate thoughts onto an innocent offer?

She couldn't tell. His expression gave nothing away except that same dark intensity that seemed to look right through her.

Her body responded before her mind could catch up. A low pulse of heat between her thighs. Her nipples tightening against the fabric of her sports bra. Wetness began to gather where she absolutely should not be getting wet while standing in a barn talking to a man who was not her husband.

"That's... that sounds helpful," she managed.

His smile deepened just a fraction, and she knew, just *knew*, that he could read every single thought racing through her mind.

"You should try Apollo first," he said.

Obinna moved and gathered Apollo's tack from the wall.

She watched his hands work the leather straps, strong fingers checking buckles and adjusting the girth. He spoke softly to the horse, his voice dropping to a register that sent shivers down her spine.

He led Apollo out of the stall. The big gelding followed him with obvious trust. Lydia walked alongside them, hyper-aware of the heat radiating from Obinna's body in the narrow aisle.

The arena was empty. Bright morning sun streamed through the high windows. Obinna brought Apollo to the mounting block and held the reins steady.

"Up you go," he said.

Lydia gripped the saddle and stepped up. Her boot found the stirrup, but as she tried to swing her leg over, Apollo shifted. She hopped down, frustrated.

"Try again."

She did. This time her foot slipped before she could get her weight up. The mounting block wobbled under her.

"One more time."

Lydia reset herself, embarrassment heating her face. She was a surgeon, for God's sake. She had the physical coordination to perform delicate procedures on beating hearts, but apparently getting on a horse was defeating her.

She gripped the pommel, foot in the stirrup, and as she pushed up she felt it.

His hand. Warm and firm, cupping her ass through her riding pants.

The touch sent a jolt straight up her spine.

He lifted. Not much. Just enough support to get her weight over. His palm pressed against her, fingers spread wide, his grip strong and sure. She felt

the heat of his skin through the fabric.

Then she was up, settled in the saddle, and his hand was gone.

Lydia stared straight ahead, pulse hammering in her ears. That was normal. Instructors helped riders mount all the time. She'd seen it a hundred times when she was younger.

But the way it felt. The way his hand had covered so much of her. Her *age*.

She couldn't stop thinking about it.

"Good," Obinna said, stepping back. "Take him around."

She nudged Apollo forward, barely registering the horse's smooth gait. Her body remembered the weight of that hand. The pressure on her ass. The warmth.

She shifted in the saddle and felt the dampness between her thighs and her face flushed with heat.

This was insane. She was wet. Actually wet. From a man helping her onto a horse.

She guided Apollo through a trot, then a canter, moving on autopilot. Her hips rocked with the rhythm and all she could think about was his hand on her ass. Those fingers. What they might feel like somewhere else. What he might look like without his shirt.

She circled back to where he stood watching, Apollo's hooves kicking up soft dirt.

"Very good," Obinna said, looking up at her. That smile again. "You have excellent control."

His voice put her into something akin to shock. So deep and confident and pleasing to the ear. His praise meant more than she wanted to admit.

Did he know? Could he tell she was a mess right now?

"Ellen's ready for you," he continued. "Take Apollo out with her. Enjoy the trail."

"Thank you." Her voice came out steadier than she felt. "For letting me ride him."

"Next week I'll have the riding machine set up." His gaze held hers. "We'll work on your form properly."

Then he turned and walked away, disappearing into the barn without looking back.

Lydia sat there, breathing hard, her thighs gripping the saddle.

Next week.

This was trouble.

Chapter Six

Phil had tried to watch the game but found it almost impossible to pay attention to what was going on.

A charge had been building. It had been building all week and he couldn't put his finger on what it was or where it was coming from.

It had to do with Lydia. And it had to do with riding lessons.

He'd been able to sense her growing excitement as the week wore on, though he hadn't dared comment on it.

She got cagey if he pointed these things out. Flighty, like a cornered animal.

But he was certain there was something going on there. He could almost smell it.

And then there was the handjob. That incredible event from the previous Sunday where she'd turned into such a deliciously dirty slut and sucked his cock and jerked him off right where he was sitting right now.

He'd indulged the memory throughout the week and, being a man, nurtured the hope that perhaps this week's riding lesson might have a similar effect on her.

He'd spent a good amount of time wondering what it was about the riding lessons that could have provoked her?

It certainly hadn't been Susan.

He'd never been on a horse in his life but imagined that there might be something to riding a powerful animal that might appeal to women. A strong body between the thighs. Leather rubbing against the groin.

He'd never say something like that out loud but it didn't take much to connect the dots there. Was that why it was mostly women who were drawn to riding?

All of those thoughts kept him sufficiently distracted from the game and that made him a little antsy. He'd found himself glancing out the window as the day wore on. Checking to see if Lydia had pulled into the driveway.

He hadn't felt like cooking and asked her if it would be okay if they just ordered pizza and she'd said that would be fine.

He jumped when he saw the flicker of headlights in the driveway. He got up off the couch and walked to the door and peered through the little window beside it.

His heart did a little dance when he saw Lydia sitting in the car.

She didn't look worried this time. Not at all. Quite the opposite. Her hands were still on the wheel but her eyes were closed.

He could see her nostrils flaring as she drew in deep breaths.

Excitement fluttered through him. It wasn't so much that this sort of behaviour was unusual. Everyone could take a little moment to themselves after pulling into the driveway.

It was that it was so unusual for *Lydia*.

The woman had nerves of steel. Years of being a cardiothoracic surgeon had honed not just her steady hands but also an imperviousness to emotion.

It wasn't that she didn't feel things. It was that she never let it show.

Sitting in that car she was definitely feeling something. Phil was witnessing what it looked like when she let it show.

He jumped back from the window when she opened her eyes and looked straight at him. He cursed himself, wondering if she'd seen him and whether she'd come in asking what it was he was doing spying on her from the front door?

He bounded across the living room and threw himself onto the couch, splaying out in a lazy pose and trying to control his breathing like he'd been lying there all day.

The front door opened with a click.

Lydia stepped into the house. She carried her riding jacket in one hand and her helmet under her other arm. Her hair fell in messy waves around her face, strands clinging to her temples. The top two buttons of her riding shirt hung open, showing just a hint of her cleavage. The smell of her sweaty body after a workout drifted across the room. There was another smell lurking in there. A smell Phil couldn't identify but one that made him think of sex.

He got up casually from the couch.

"How was your lesson?"

She drew in a breath and pressed a hand to her stomach.

"My core is screaming. I forgot how much work it takes to stay balanced on a horse."

She wasn't gushing about the lesson like she had last week but there was something different about her. Something unsettled again.

"What did you do?"

She regarded him for a moment like she wasn't sure she wanted to tell him.

"Ellen and I did another trail ride. We went further this time. Into the woods behind the property."

"That sounds nice."

"It was." She paused. "I got to ride Apollo."

"Apollo?"

"Obinna's horse." Her voice went flat. "He's the owner."

Phil felt something tighten in his chest.

"I know who he is."

"Oh." She blinked. "Right. You met him when you bought the lessons."

"Yeah."

She walked past him toward the kitchen and set her helmet on the counter. Phil followed.

"So Obinna let you ride his personal horse, huh?"

"Ellen suggested it. She said I was ready for a challenge."

The way she said it made Phil's skin prickle. There was something there. There was something around Obinna, or his horse, that made her lips take that shape they made when she wasn't being one hundred percent forthcoming.

She wasn't lying. Lydia didn't lie. But she was telling stories. Rearranging things for how she thought they should have gone.

"And was he? Challenging?"

"Very." Lydia turned on the tap and filled a glass with water. She drank it in long gulps. When she finished, she wiped her mouth with the back of her hand. "He's powerful. Responsive, but you have to know what you're doing or he'll take advantage of you."

Phil bit back a smile. There it was. That was the story. There was something challenging that had happened at the barn but it hadn't been the fucking horse. He leaned against the counter.

"Sounds like you handled him."

"I did." She set the glass down. "Obinna watched me ride. He said my form needed work."

There it was again. That name. The shape of her mouth. Obinna was the challenge.

You have to know what you're doing or he'll take advantage of you.

Something started expanding inside his chest. A weird excitement. Lydia was *going through* something. She was going through something in a way she hadn't in years.

"He watched you?"

"He was there when we got back from the trail. He, uh, wants to work on my posture next week."

Phil's nostrils flared and he drew a breath in slowly. Posture? Right.

He wasn't the kind of guy to get his hackles up about another man paying attention to his wife. Other men did that all the time. She was smart and she was gorgeous. Part of being married to her was dealing with other guys trying to bag her. He'd gotten used to it and it didn't faze him anymore.

Except...

Except now *she* seemed fazed. Telling stories about being challenged and knowing what she was doing.

Lydia was competent at almost everything she did and competent people didn't go around bragging about their competence. Like truly rich people didn't talk about their wealth.

He tried to keep his voice light. "Your posture looks fine to me."

She shook her head and chuckled. "It's not the same thing." She unbuttoned another button on her shirt and fanned herself. "God, I'm hot."

He watched her fingers move to the fourth button.

"You want me to turn up the air?"

"Haha. It's January. No. I'm going to shower."

She walked past him again and this time he caught her wrist.

"Lyd."

She stopped and looked at him. Her pupils were wide. Her breathing was shallow.

"What?"

"Everything okay?"

"Why wouldn't it be?"

"I don't know. You seem...not as excited as you were last week."

"Oh. Really? Oh. I'm sorry! No I've...honestly my mind's still at the barn. I..." She pointed a finger up at the ceiling. "There was this one...it's a riding thing. I'm not going to bore you with the details. I'm really happy that I'm doing this. Thank-you again for the lessons."

He nodded.

She smiled. She left him standing in the kitchen and he heard her footsteps on the stairs. He heard the bathroom door close. Heard the shower turn on.

Phil stood there for a long moment.

Obinna.

The name sat in his head like a stone.

He thought about the man he'd met at the stables. The way Obinna had asked about Lydia. The way he'd looked at Phil when he mentioned her profession.

Phil walked back to the living room and sat on the couch.

He told himself once more he wasn't the kind of guy to get his hackles up about other men looking at his wife. He wasn't.

But this wasn't about Obinna looking at his wife, was it?

It wasn't.

Something about the man had provoked something inside her. Something she found challenging to deal with. Something she needed to tell herself she *knew what she was doing* with. Or it might get the better of her.

He contemplated the possibility that he was just making all of this up. That it was all just in his head. Because he was a man. Because his man-radar had detected something peripherally sexual was going on here. And because of that he had to weave a story about Lydia he could swallow.

He shook his head.

It wasn't that. Something was up. Riding lessons weren't just about the horse anymore.

For some reason he found that deeply intriguing and exciting.

Chapter Seven

They ate pizza and watched the last season of *Trigger* that they'd been meaning to get to.

The whole time they were on the couch he was on edge. Every time Lydia moved he started to wonder if she was going to make a move on him. Like last week.

Each time he was disappointed.

He hadn't necessarily been expecting something to happen one hundred percent for sure. But he'd been holding hope it might.

What she'd done last week on the couch had been so fucking hot.

He didn't mention it when she yawned and looked at him with sleepy eyes, telling him it was getting close to bed time. He was too old to try and put the moves on her if she wasn't into it herself.

There had been a time when that was kind of sexy. Convincing her. Maybe even doing it when she was a little reluctant. But that time was over. Now it had to be enthusiastic consent or nothing.

She didn't look too consenting in her grey sweat pants and t-shirt, her hands still stained with spots of pizza grease.

When she got up he grabbed the pizza box and headed for the kitchen.

Upstairs Phil stood at the sink brushing his teeth, watching Lydia in the mirror as she did the same at her sink. The bathroom was quiet except for the sound of bristles against enamel and the occasional spit into porcelain.

His eyes drifted down to her chest. Her nipples pressed against the thin fabric of her t-shirt, visible through the grey cotton. He felt his cock twitch in his boxer briefs.

She was still in incredible shape. All those mornings at the gym, the strict diet she kept to even when he wanted to order takeout. Her body looked almost the same as it had twenty years ago.

He wanted her. Still wanted her after all this time.

They spat into their respective sinks and wiped their mouths with towels. Phil followed Lydia into the bedroom, his eyes on her back, on the way her hips moved in those sweatpants.

He reached for the bathroom light switch and flipped it off.

When he turned around, Lydia was pulling her t-shirt over her head. Her breasts came into view, pale and firm in the dim light from the bedside lamp. She tossed the shirt onto the chair in the corner, then hooked her thumbs into her sweatpants and pushed them down her legs.

Phil drew in a breath and held it.

She was in just her underwear now. White cotton panties that hugged her hips and no bra.

She crawled into bed and pulled the covers up to her waist, leaving her breasts exposed as she reached for her phone on the nightstand.

Phil stood there, unsure of what to do. She never did this. They used to sleep naked together all the time, years ago. Before the kids. Before life got

busier and sleep became more valuable than sex. Now they both wore full pyjamas to bed.

His cock twitched, pressing against his boxer briefs.

He killed the overhead light and made his way to his side of the bed. The mattress dipped as he climbed in. He lay on his back, staring at the ceiling, acutely aware of Lydia's bare skin inches away from him.

She scrolled through her phone, the blue light illuminating her face. Phil could see her breasts in his peripheral vision. He could see the rise and fall of her chest with each breath.

He didn't know what this meant. Was she inviting him to touch her? Or was she just hot and decided to sleep in less clothing?

His hands stayed at his sides, fingers drumming against his thighs.

A silence stretched between them. She kept scrolling, completely absorbed in whatever she was reading. Her free hand rested on her stomach, just above the waistband of her panties.

Phil's mind raced. Should he say something? Should he reach over and touch her? What if she rejected him? What if she got annoyed that he'd misread the situation?

He stayed still, his erection slowly growing, his eyes fixed on the ceiling fan that wasn't moving.

Lydia set her phone on the nightstand. She rolled onto her side to face him, then propped herself up on one elbow.

His eyes darted to the way it made her breasts sag to one side slightly.

"You want a formal, written invitation or something?" she asked.

He let out an awkward, snuffling chuckle. "I, uh, I just wasn't sure whether..."

What to say? Whether you wanted me to try and fuck you or not?

Lydia reached down and picked up his hand. She pressed his palm against her breast.

Phil cupped it, feeling its weight and warmth.

Her nipple hardened against his skin. He rolled her onto her back and shifted closer, his thumb circling the stiffened bud.

She watched him with half-closed eyes.

He leaned over her chest and took her nipple into his mouth. The taste of her skin filled his senses as he sucked gently, then harder when she arched into him.

"That's nice," she breathed.

He moved his hand down her stomach, his fingers trailing over her smooth skin until they reached the waistband of her panties. He slipped beneath the cotton and felt heat and dampness.

She was already wet.

His cock throbbed. This was part of it. Part of whatever shift had happened since she started those lessons. Sex on a Sunday. After the barn. After seeing Obinna.

Phil pushed the thought away and hooked his fingers into her panties. He peeled them down her thighs, over her knees, off her ankles. She spread her legs as he crawled down between them.

The smell hit him. Her feminine scent, musky and sweet, that always made him harder. He lowered his face and took her pussy into his mouth.

She gasped.

He licked her, tasting the slightly sweet liquid that had gathered there. His tongue moved through her folds, finding her clit and circling it. Her hips rocked in time with his licking.

Her fingers threaded through his hair, gripping, positioning his mouth exactly where she wanted it.

He kept going, alternating between broad strokes and focused attention on her clit. Her breathing quickened. Her thighs tensed against his shoulders.

Phil glanced up. Her breasts rose and fell with her breaths. Her eyes were closed, her head tilted back against the pillow.

She was somewhere else. Deep in her mind. Lost in whatever thoughts had driven her there.

What was she thinking about? Who was she thinking about?

The question excited him.

Was she still back at the barn? Was she thinking of her posture, of Obinna looking on as she rode his horse?

His tongue worked faster.

Her grip on his hair tightened, almost painful now. Her hips lifted off the bed, pressing her pussy harder against his mouth.

"Don't stop," she whispered.

He didn't.

Her body went rigid. A long, low moan escaped her lips. Her thighs clamped around his head as she came, her pussy pulsing against his tongue.

Phil lingered there while her breathing settled, his face still buried between her legs. The scent of her filled his nose. The taste lingered on his tongue.

Finally, her grip on his hair loosened. Her thighs relaxed.

He lifted his head and wiped his mouth with the back of his hand. She lay sprawled on the bed, one arm draped across her forehead, chest still heaving slightly.

Phil crawled up between her legs, his cock rigid and aching.

Lydia opened her thighs wider, her eyes locked on him as he positioned himself at her entrance. The look on her face was hungry and focused and it sent a jolt through him.

She reached down and wrapped her fingers around his shaft. The contact made him twitch in her grip. She rubbed the head along her pussy lips, coating him in her wetness, dragging it through her folds slowly.

He held his breath as her wetness coated him.

She guided him to her pussy opening and placed her other hand on his ass, pulling him forward. He slid into her and she tightened around him.

"That's nice," she breathed.

He sank deeper, taking his time. Savouring the ever novel delight of being sheathed inside his woman.

Her pussy gripped him, tight and slick.

Gripped by lust, he lowered his mouth to hers and pushed his tongue past her lips. She moaned into his mouth, arching her back as he started to thrust. Her pussy clamped down on his cock with each movement.

Her hands slid up his back, fingers splayed across his shoulder blades. The gentle pressure urged him on, guiding his rhythm.

Lydia locked her legs around his thighs. The shift pulled him even deeper.

"God," she moaned.

He drove into her, his hips snapping forward. Her pussy was so wet he could feel it running down onto her ass, pooling beneath her. Each time his balls slapped against that firm flesh they came away soaked.

Her nails dug into his back.

He kept thrusting, harder now, the bed creaking beneath them with each impact. Her breasts bounced with the force of it. Her mouth hung open, small gasps escaping with every stroke.

Then her eyes squeezed shut. Her whole body went rigid.

She was coming again.

Her pussy clenched around his cock, rhythmic pulses that felt like her body was milking him. Trying to pull the cum right out of his balls.

Phil grunted. The sensation pushed him over the edge.

His orgasm hit hard and blurred his vision. He buried himself to the hilt and held there, his cock spasming inside her. Hot spurts of cum erupted from him, flooding her pussy. Each pulse sent another wave of amazing pleasure through his body.

The bed creaked as he jerked against her, emptying himself. He could feel it leaving his balls and shooting into her body.

Lydia's legs tightened around him, holding him deep as he finished.

He collapsed onto her, his face pressed against her neck. His chest heaved against hers. Sweat slicked their skin where their bodies met.

Her hands moved to his hair, fingers running through it gently now. The earlier urgency had drained away, replaced by something softer.

He stayed inside her, still semi-hard, neither of them moving to separate. His cum leaked out around his cock, warm and slick between them.

"Jesus," he muttered against her skin.

Lydia hummed in agreement. Her fingers continued their slow path through his hair.

Phil shifted his weight to one elbow so he wasn't crushing her. When he looked down at her face, her eyes were closed. A small smile played at the corners of her mouth.

She looked satisfied. Thoroughly fucked and content.

He wanted to ask what had gotten into her. What had changed these past two weeks. But he didn't want to muddy the nice moment with analysis.

Lydia's eyes opened and met his. She ran a finger along his jaw.

"That was good," she said simply.

Phil nodded. It had been. Better than good.

He slowly pulled out of her, both of them wincing slightly at the loss of contact. His cum spilled out of her pussy as he withdrew, a thick trail of it running down to the sheets.

He paused on his knees, his gaze captivated by the mess he'd made inside her.

Her usual shyness didn't surface. She didn't modestly close her legs or cover herself. She laid there, splayed wide open, her engorged folds leaking his milky secretion.

His cock twitched to life when she put her hand between her legs and drew her middle finger along the length of her slit. She dipped it in and swirled it around, then pulled it out coated in his semen.

She let out a soft chuckle as she rolled onto her side and pulled the sheets over herself. "Men," she whispered.

Chapter Eight

Ellen gave her a funny look as she stepped up to Butterscotch's stable and leaned against the door. "Hey Lydia!" she said.

"Ready to ride?" Lydia asked.

Ellen chuckled and gave the horse's neck a slow rub. "Um, so, actually, I think you belong to Obinna today."

Lydia drew in a quick breath at her phrasing. Her mind darted to a dirty place, which it had become unnervingly adept at doing in the last week. "What do you mean?" she said, keeping her tone as calm as she could manage.

Ellen shifted her weight, clearly uncomfortable. "Um, yeah, so he asked me to send you to the second floor above the arena when you got here. He's got the riding machine set up."

Heat crawled up Lydia's neck. The riding machine. Her brain conjured an image of herself straddling it while Obinna stood close, adjusting her hips, his hands on her body.

"He wants to work on your form," Ellen continued, oblivious to Lydia's internal struggle. "Said last week you were still too tense through your

lower back. The machine helps isolate problem areas."

"Oh," Lydia said, nodding slightly. "I guess that would be fine. We'll still get a chance to go out on our ride though, won't we?"

"Oh for sure!" Ellen replied. "It shouldn't take too long."

Lydia eyed her. There was something definitely different about her demeanour. "Is there something else I should know about?" she asked with a laugh, trying to lighten the mood between them.

Ellen let out an awkward chuckle and shifted her weight again, toeing the ground with her boot. "So, uh, there's this thing..." She trailed off, then started again. "The machine can be a little...intense."

Lydia's stomach flipped. Her mind immediately conjured images that had nothing to do with riding technique. "Intense how?"

"It's just..." Ellen's face went pink. "Look, Obinna is a wonderful man, really professional, and I would never say anything to him about this, but the saddle on that machine? It moves in all these directions, and sometimes it kind of... rubs."

"Rubs."

"Yeah." Ellen wouldn't meet her eyes. "Down there. You know."

Lydia felt heat crawl up her neck. She forced a laugh that came out too high. "Oh. That's...good to know."

Ellen laughed with her, but it sounded strained. "I just wanted to warn you. Some women find it distracting."

Distracting. Lydia's pulse quickened. She'd been distracted for days. Distracted by thoughts of Obinna's hands on her waist, distracted while operating, distracted in bed with Phil. Her body hummed with a constant low-grade arousal that made no sense. She'd masturbated more in the past week than in the past year.

"I think I can probably handle it," Lydia said.

Ellen studied her face for a moment, then nodded. "Okay. Just...don't feel like you have to push through if it gets uncomfortable."

They walked through the barn and climbed a set of wooden stairs at the far end. The second floor opened into a large room overlooking the riding arena. Windows lined one wall, letting in pale morning light. In the centre sat the mechanical horse. A saddle mounted on a complex base of pistons and gears.

Obinna stood beside it, one hand resting on the saddle. He wore a black henley that hugged his chest and jeans that sat low on his hips. When he saw them, his mouth curved into something that wasn't quite a smile.

"Mrs. Ackerman," he said.

Lydia's mouth went dry. "Lydia. Please."

"Lydia." The way he said her name felt like he was tasting it. "Wonderful of you to come."

Lydia eyed the contraption and smiled.

Ellen cleared her throat. "I'll just...I'll be downstairs if you need anything." She turned and shuffled quickly out of the room.

Obinna moved around the machine, checking something on the control panel mounted to the wall. "You don't mind, do you? You ride just fine but I can see you carry some tension in your hips. Was your belly sore after last week?" he asked, rubbing his stomach.

"It was, actually," she replied. "I didn't realize it was that noticeable."

"Everything is noticeable when you know what to look for." He gestured to the machine. "This will help you feel where you're fighting the movement instead of flowing with it."

Lydia approached the mechanical horse. Up close, she could see the saddle was fitted with sensors, small LEDs blinking along the edges. The leather looked well-worn and shaped by many riders.

She wondered if Ellen had been exaggerating about what she'd said. Perhaps she'd had a bad experience on the machine herself? It was hard to see how it could rub the wrong way.

"Go ahead," Obinna said. "Mount up."

She grabbed the pommel and swung her leg over, settling into the saddle. The leather creaked beneath her weight. Her thighs gripped the barrel of the horse, and she adjusted her seat, trying to find a comfortable position.

Obinna circled her slowly. "Feet in the stirrups."

She complied, hyperaware of his gaze tracking every movement.

"Now," he said, stopping in front of the control panel, "we start slow."

He pressed a button. The machine hummed to life.

The machine started with a gentle rolling motion, mimicking a horse's walk. Lydia's hips moved with it, forward and back, her body remembering the rhythm from years ago.

Obinna watched her with an intensity that made her skin prickle. His eyes tracked the movement of her hips, the angle of her spine, the tension in her shoulders. She hadn't felt this observed since med school. Like she was a specimen under glass.

"Relax your lower back," he said. "Let the movement come from your hips."

She tried to loosen up, rolling her pelvis with the motion. The saddle shifted beneath her, and something firm pressed through her riding pants.

She drew another quick breath.

"Good," Obinna said, his voice low. "That's better."

The machine continued its steady rhythm. Rock forward, rock back. Each time she moved forward, that spot behind the pommel pressed against her. Not hard, just a gentle pressure that sent a small jolt through her body.

Lydia forced out a nervous laugh. Her face was getting hot. She could feel exactly what Ellen had warned her about. The saddle wasn't just moving her hips. It was rubbing directly against her clit.

Obinna's eyes stayed on her. "Everything alright?"

She nodded quickly, not trusting her voice. Her cheeks burned. She could feel herself getting wet, her panties dampening with each forward motion of the saddle.

"We can stop if you're uncomfortable."

"No," she said, though it came out too fast. "No, I'm fine. It's fine."

She wasn't about to admit what was happening. Wasn't about to tell this man that his machine was turning her on.

This Pavlovian response to the mechanical stimulation was mortifying.

Obinna studied her for another moment, then nodded. "Let's try a canter."

He pressed another button.

The machine's tempo increased. The rolling motion became faster, more insistent. Rock forward, rock back, rock forward, rock back. The pressure against her clit came in steady pulses now, each one sending heat shooting through her core and blossoming up into her chest.

She bit her lip hard. Her thighs clenched around the barrel of the horse, trying to tighten her grip. Trying to control the sensation building between her legs. But clenching only made it worse, pressing her harder against that spot.

"Breathe," Obinna said. "You're holding your breath."

She sucked in air, her chest rising and falling. The movement made her hips shift in the saddle, grinding her against the pressure point. A small sound escaped her throat before she could stop it.

Obinna's expression didn't change, but something flickered in his eyes. Recognition of what was happening, perhaps?

The thought sent humiliation flooding through her.

"Your form is improving," he said, his voice perfectly professional. "See how your hips are moving with the motion now instead of fighting it?"

She nodded, still not trusting herself to speak. Her panties were soaked now, clinging to her. Every forward rock of the saddle dragged the seam of her riding pants across her swollen clit. The friction was maddening and relentless.

"Keep your shoulders back," Obinna continued, circling around behind her. "Good. Yes, just like that."

His voice came from somewhere over her shoulder now, but she couldn't turn to look at him. Couldn't do anything but grip the pommel and try not to moan as the machine worked her body, each mechanical thrust pushing her closer to something she absolutely could not let happen here. Not now. Not in front of him.

The scent hit her nose, musky and unmistakable. Her own arousal, sharp in the air. Her stomach clenched with humiliation. Could he smell it? She caught Obinna's nostrils flare slightly as he circled back to the control panel.

He knew. He had to know.

"Let's try a gallop," he said, his finger hovering over the next button.

"I don't think..." she began, but the machine lurched into a new rhythm before she could finish.

The saddle bucked beneath her, fast and hard. Her hips slammed forward and back, the pressure against her clit now constant and unrelenting. She gripped the pommel with white knuckles, her thighs shaking.

"Oh god," she whispered.

The wet spot in her riding pants grew. She could feel it spreading, soaking through the fabric. Each forward thrust dragged the seam across her swollen flesh. Her clit throbbed, engorged and sensitive. Warm pressure built low in her belly, coiling tighter with each movement of the machine.

Obinna stepped closer. "May I correct your posture?"

She nodded. Her breath came in short gasps now.

He moved behind her, then his hand pressed flat against her lower abdomen. Warm and firm. His other hand touched her lower back, tilting her hips forward.

The new angle sent the saddle directly onto her clit.

"There," he said. "Feel the difference?"

The pressure exploded. White heat flooded through her body. Her pussy clenched hard, then released in a violent spasm. Hot fluid gushed from her, soaking through her panties and riding pants in one wet rush.

"Ah! Ah!" The sounds tore from her throat, raw and desperate.

Her hips bucked against the machine as another wave hit. More fluid poured out of her, running down her inner thighs and dripping onto the floor beneath the mechanical horse. The puddle spread across the wood planks.

She tried to speak, to tell him to stop, but her mouth wouldn't form the words. Only ragged moans as her pussy contracted again and again, squeezing out more wetness with each spasm.

"Please!" she finally gasped. "Please stop!"

The machine went silent immediately.

Lydia sat there trembling, her body still twitching with aftershocks. The saddle beneath her was slick with her juices. She could feel it coating her inner thighs, warm and sticky.

"Lydia," Obinna said, reaching for her.

"Don't!" She thrust her hand out, stopping him. Tears streamed down her face. "Don't touch me."

She swung her leg over the saddle, nearly slipping on the wet leather. Her legs buckled when she hit the ground. She caught herself on the machine's base, then stumbled toward the bathroom she'd spotted in the corner.

"Let me help!"

"No!" She sobbed, lurching away from him. Her riding pants clung to her legs, the wet fabric chafing with each step. She could smell herself. That sharp, unmistakable stench of sex.

She reached the bathroom and slammed the door behind her. The lock clicked. Her back hit the wall and she slid down, landing hard on the tile floor.

Her whole body shook. Not just from the orgasm, though it still pulsed through her in fading waves, but from the sheer mortification of what had just happened.

She'd come. In front of Obinna. On his machine. So hard she'd soaked through her clothes and left a puddle on his floor.

Through the door, she heard his footsteps. Then nothing.

Lydia pressed her face into her hands and wept.

Chapter Nine

Her sobs had turned to sniffles by the time the knock came on the bathroom door. She'd reasoned herself out the worst of her hysteria. She was a fucking surgeon. Sometimes weird stuff happened to your body.

This was nothing to be ashamed of.

She wiped her nose and picked herself up off the floor. "Who is it?" she asked.

"Lydia? It's me, Ellen."

Ellen's muffled voice brought a slight relief. At least she would have another woman to commiserate with.

She walked to the door, undid the deadbolt and pulled it open a hair. "Is he with you?" she asked.

Ellen shook her head. "He's down in his office," she explained.

Lydia opened the door wider and let her in.

Ellen slipped inside with a stack of folded towels under one arm and fresh clothes draped over the other. A plastic bag hung from her finger. "I brought you some things," she said quietly, setting them on the counter.

Lydia recognized a pair of riding pants and what looked like new underwear still in the package. Her face burned hotter.

"Look, it happens more than you'd think," Ellen continued, her voice gentle. "The machine's designed for balance training, but the saddle..."

"Ellen." Lydia held up a hand. "I'm a surgeon. I don't need to be placated about having an orgasm in front of my riding instructor."

Ellen's mouth snapped shut.

A silence stretched between them. Lydia closed her eyes, mortification flooding through her again. "God. I'm sorry. That was rude." She pressed her palms against her temples. "I'm obviously out of my element here."

"It's okay." Ellen's expression softened. "Really."

Lydia knelt and started unlacing her boots, her fingers clumsy. She yanked them off, then stood and peeled her riding pants down her legs. The wet fabric clung to her thighs. She stepped out of them, then hooked her thumbs into her soaked underwear and pulled those down too.

Ellen turned her back without being asked, facing the door.

Lydia tore open the package of fresh panties and stepped into them, grateful for Ellen's discretion. She pulled the riding pants on.

She picked up the plastic bag and stuffed her ruined clothes into the small trash bin.

"Do you want to talk about what happened?" Ellen asked, still facing away.

"No." Lydia's voice came out flat. She sat on the closed toilet lid to pull her boots back on. "It's been really nice getting to know you, Ellen. But I obviously can't ever come back here."

"Obinna will be disappointed to hear that."

Lydia's hands stilled on her laces. She looked up at Ellen's back. "What?"

Ellen turned around now, her expression wary. Confused, almost. "He's really taken a liking to you."

"I don't understand. I've barely spoken with him."

Ellen studied her face, as if searching for something. The silence grew uncomfortable.

"Can I ask you something?" Ellen asked.

The tone of her voice implied the conversation was about to get even more uncomfortable.

"I guess," Lydia replied.

"Are you and your husband into the lifestyle?" Ellen asked.

"Lifestyle?" Lydia finished tying her boot and stood. "What lifestyle?"

Ellen's eyebrows rose. "You really don't know?"

"Know what?" Irritation crept into Lydia's voice. Her humiliation was already complete. She didn't need riddles on top of it.

Ellen crossed her arms. "The hotwife thing. Cuckolding. Whatever you want to call it."

The words hung in the air like a foreign language. Lydia stared at her.

"When your husband came to book lessons, Obinna asked him about you. About your marriage. He does that with women he's interested in." Ellen's tone remained matter-of-fact, clinical even. "Your husband gave him the green light."

"The green light for what?" Lydia's pulse hammered in her ears.

"For Obinna to pursue you." Ellen tilted her head. "You're telling me you had no idea?"

Lydia's legs went weak. She leaned against the sink. Phil. Phil had talked to Obinna about their marriage? Had given some kind of permission?

"That's insane," she whispered.

Ellen shrugged. "Maybe. But Obinna wouldn't have touched you today if he didn't think your husband was on board. He's careful about that."

Touched her. Those hands on her hips. The way he'd increased the machine's speed, watching her face.

"This is a mistake," Lydia said. "Phil wouldn't...we're not..."

But even as she said it, fragments reassembled in her mind. Phil's questions after her first lesson. His eagerness when she came home flushed. The way he'd watched her in the kitchen, asking about Obinna.

"I'm sorry if I created some sort of misunderstanding," Ellen said.

Lydia barely heard the words. Her mind was spinning. Permission? Phil had given Obinna permission to pursue her?

Ellen's admission collided with all of the dirty thoughts Lydia had been trying to keep out of her mind all week. She couldn't believe what she was hearing, what Ellen was telling her.

"Do you need a glass of water or something? You're looking a little pale," Ellen said, concern furrowing her brow.

She needed one thing. Air.

She stumbled past Ellen and down the stairs. Out into the parking lot where the cold air hit her and set her mind straight. She stood there leaning against the wall of the barn and dragging in huge lungfuls of air. Not caring about who was watching or what had just happened.

She needed to talk to Phil.

The sound of the front door clicking open caught him off guard and literally with his pants down.

He jumped in his seat, scrambling to close the porn playing on his computer and pull up his jeans at the same time. He managed to mute the clip and yank his underwear on. Then he mashed the off button on the monitor and zipped up, tugging his belt tight over the open button of his jeans.

"Phil? You here?" Lydia called out from the hall.

Worry flooded through him. Had something happened? Had she been in an accident? Had she fallen off the horse? She was at least an hour early getting home.

He looked down and saw the boner he'd been stroking slowly deflating. He pressed his hands over his groin to help it along. "In here! I'll be right out!" he shouted.

He glanced in the mirror to make sure nothing else was out of place from jerking off, then put on a fresh smile and stepped out into the hallway.

"Lyd? What are you doing home so early babe?"

Something shifted in her face the moment she looked at him.

Phil's stomach dropped. The way she stood there with her hair dishevelled and her cheeks flushed. It reminded him of how she'd looked after those other riding lessons.

This was different. She really did look like she'd flown off a horse.

Her eyes locked onto his with a frightening intensity.

He noticed her pants. He'd never seen those before. Brown leggings that hugged her thighs. Not the riding breeches she'd left in this morning.

"Lyd?" He moved toward her, reaching for her arm. His pulse hammered in his ears. "Everything okay?"

"I did it." Her voice came out breathy, almost trembling.

His hand tightened on her forearm. "Did what?" he asked.

"I had sex with Obinna."

Time seemed to slow as he absorbed what she'd said.

His knees went weak. The hallway tilted around him. His cock, which had barely started to soften, surged back to full hardness in seconds, straining against his zipper.

"You...what?" The question came out as a strangled gasp.

She stepped closer. Her hand reached down and pressed against the bulge in his jeans, fingers tracing the outline of his erection through the denim.

"I couldn't help myself." Her whisper sent shivers down his spine. "He had me on that riding machine, and it was rubbing me, Phil. Right between my legs. I got so turned on I couldn't think straight."

Phil's vision blurred at the edges. This had to be a dream. Had to be. But her hand felt real. The heat coming off her body felt real. The smell of sweat and musky arousal was real.

She'd done it? She'd had sex with fucking Obinna?!?

She popped the button of his jeans and slid her hand inside, past his waistband, wrapping her fingers around him through his underwear.

"Phil, you're so hard."

He was. God, he was harder than he'd ever been in his life.

The mental image of Lydia letting Obinna into herself made him dizzy. Made him sick. Made him want to explode right there in her hand.

"Tell me." His voice cracked. "Tell me what happened."

Her hand moved up and down, slow and deliberate. "After I came on the machine, he followed me outside. I was so embarrassed. So wet. Ellen told me you gave your permission."

Phil's brain stuttered. Permission. Had he? He'd talked to Obinna that first day, but they'd only...

"Did you?" Lydia's eyes searched his face. "Did you tell him he could?"

"I..." Phil couldn't form words. Her hand tightened around him.

"It doesn't matter." She pulled his underwear down and gripped him skin to skin. "Because I wanted it. I wanted him."

The confession made his knees buckle. He grabbed the wall for support.

"He took me into his office." Her strokes picked up speed. "Bent me over his desk and pulled my pants down. I was dripping, Phil. I've never been that wet in my life."

Phil groaned. His hips bucked into her fist involuntarily.

"He's huge." Her whisper came right against his ear now. "I could barely take him. But I did. I let him inside me and I loved it."

The orgasm ripped through him without warning. He gasped, his whole body seizing as he came all over her hand, hot spurts coating her fingers and dripping onto the hardwood floor.

Lydia kept stroking him through it, milking every last drop, her eyes locked on his face the entire time.

Chapter Ten

She only felt the slightest bit of guilt at the dark arousal crawling through her. She looked down at her hand, coated in Phil's sticky seed.

This was possibly the cruellest and most dishonest thing she'd ever done to him and she only regretted it a little bit.

Because his reaction was what she'd hoped it would be. All the way home she'd schemed about this, trying to think of the best way to elicit this admission while at the same time gain the acknowledgement that this might be something Phil wanted.

The admission and acknowledgement currently coated her hand.

"Lydia what the fuck?" Phil gasped, pulling his cock out of her grasp and stuffing it into his pants, his face burning up with embarrassment.

It was so unlike her to do anything like this. They were a team. They acted together not against one another. "I have a confession to make," she whispered.

"Another one?" Phil gasped.

"I didn't sleep with Obinna."

Phil stared at her, his chest heaving. His spent cock twitched in his pants. The admission hung heavy between them.

"What?"

"I didn't have sex with him." Lydia's voice stayed steady, clinical almost. She held up her hand, his cum still clinging to her fingers, a drop falling to the hardwood floor. "I lied."

"You...what the hell, Lydia?"

"I don't know what possessed me to say that." She paused, watching the mess drip. "Or, I do. It's complicated."

Phil gawked at her, his mouth half-open.

"You wanted an explanation," Lydia said. "After the riding lessons. Why I was different. Why I initiated sex. You kept wanting to ask me what was going on and I stopped you."

"Jesus Christ, Lyd..."

"This is it." She met his eyes without flinching. "I didn't know it myself. Not after the first lesson, at least. I knew it after the second. I didn't know how to tell you. Whether to tell you."

"Tell me what?" Phil's voice cracked. "Just...get to the point?"

Lydia straightened her shoulders. Her surgeon's composure returned, that unflinching directness she used when delivering difficult news to families.

"Obinna makes me horny."

He flinched as she said it.

"He makes me wet. He makes me want to suck cock and get on my knees and get fucked." She didn't look away. "I didn't have sex with him. He didn't suggest anything like that. He put me on the riding machine and Ellen warned me sometimes it pressed funny between the legs."

Phil's throat went dry.

"I came," Lydia said flatly. "On the machine. With him watching. I squirted all over the riding machine and the floor and Obinna saw it all."

Phil's eyes bugged wide open.

"I ran to the bathroom after. Ellen brought me these." Lydia gestured to the leggings she wore. "My riding pants were soaked through."

Phil looked like he was struggling to comprehend what she was telling him.

"A part of me liked it when it was happening," Lydia whispered. "Knowing he was watching. Knowing I couldn't stop it."

"Fuck," Phil breathed.

"Then Ellen asked me if we really were into the lifestyle. She said you'd given Obinna permission to pursue me. I believed her. Then I didn't. Then I thought I should just ask you. But then I came home and I didn't know what to do with that information. How to explain it. So I tested you." She looked at her hand again. "I told you I fucked him to see how you'd react."

"You tested me."

"Yes."

"By making me think..." Phil's hands shook. "By telling me another man..."

"I know." Lydia's voice softened. "It was cruel. I'm sorry. But I needed to know."

"Know what?"

"If it excited you." She stepped closer, her cum-covered hand between them. "It did." She once more looked down at the evidence of his excitement.

"I don't want to lie to you," Lydia said. "Not about this. But I needed to understand what was happening. To me. To us." She paused. "I want him. I

think about him constantly. And I needed to know if that disgusted you or..."

"Or what?"

"Or if it did something else."

The way she looked at him, the dark lust trapped in her eyes, was horrifying and thrilling at the same time.

To bear witness to this type of transformation in a woman felt like a rare privilege.

This was everything Lydia was *not*.

She was absolutely not a hussy or a slut. She was a highly trained professional woman who took herself and her life extremely seriously. Every day she took her patient's lives into her hands. She healed and helped and did her best to make the world a better place each day.

Now she was standing in their hallway, having just lied to him about fucking another man. Having lied to him to confirm for herself that the thought of Obinna Okafor fucking her excited him.

His eyes sank to the drying mess of evidence on her hand.

That, too, was a jarring sight. Lydia coming home and casually masturbating him in the front hallway while spinning lies about getting fucked by her riding instructor.

This was what he'd been sensing from her each time she got home from the barn. This was the change that had made her blow him on the couch, then initiate sex with him the next week.

Her story still seemed a little convoluted. But he was certain that was just because she was still untangling it herself and not that she was holding back or lying to him again.

"Should we get you washed up?" he asked, not sure where else to start this awkward conversation.

She looked down at her hand so casually and shrugged. "Sure," she said.

He led her to the bathroom and wiped the mess away with a wad of toilet paper, then let her wash her hand. Then he led her to the couch and sat down next to her, putting a hand on her thigh.

The heady and arousing stink of her sex organ wafted up from between her legs. The smell of her cunt wet for another man.

"I'm not really sure where to start?" he said.

"I'm not either?" she replied.

"Okay..." He drew in a breath and leaned back against the couch. "Is this...is this something you want to pursue?" he asked quietly.

He nearly let out a wild and disbelieving laugh at what he'd just said. Was he really asking Lydia if she was interested in having sex with another man?

She studied her lap for a few long moments, then turned her head to look at him.

"I don't know what I want," she said finally.

Phil shifted closer, keeping his hand on her thigh. "Well, let's figure it out together." Still felt bizarre talking about this so openly. But it didn't upset him as much as he would have guessed.

They were two mature, consenting adults. She wasn't talking about cheating on him, betraying him. She was talking about taking a lover.

Thinking of it that way stabbed him right in the centre of the chest.

She nodded but didn't speak.

"Do you want to see him again?" Phil asked.

"An hour ago I would have told you no. An hour ago I would have told you I'm never setting foot in that barn again."

He let a few moments of silence pass, giving her time to think. "What about now?" he asked, keeping his voice low and therapeutic.

Lydia's jaw tightened. She looked away, staring at the wall across from them. "Yes," she whispered. "I want to see him again."

Phil's stomach lurched. He'd expected the answer, but hearing it out loud was different. His cock stirred in his pants despite the jealousy twisting in his chest.

"What is it about him?" Phil asked.

"I don't know."

"Lydia."

She drew in a slow breath. "He's...different. He looks at me like he knows something I don't. Like he can see right through me." Her fingers twisted together in her lap. "And his hands. When he touched my hips today, I thought I was going to pass out."

Phil's pulse quickened. The image of Obinna's hands on her body made him breathless.

"Has he said anything to you? About wanting...more?"

"No," she replied, shaking her head. "Well, not directly. But the way he looks at me..." She trailed off, her cheeks flushing. "Ellen said he's interested in me."

"Ellen said that?"

"Yes. She said you gave him permission to pursue me."

Phil froze. "What?"

"That's what she told me. That you two had talked and you were okay with it."

His mind raced back to that first visit to Heavenly Hills. Obinna's probing questions about Lydia. The knowing look in his eyes. Had the man been planning this from the beginning?

"I never said that," Phil said carefully. "We talked. He asked about you. But I didn't give him permission for anything."

Lydia turned to face him fully. "So Ellen lied?"

"Maybe she misunderstood something. Or maybe Obinna told her something that wasn't true." Phil rubbed his face. "But that's not the point right now. The point is what you want."

"I don't know what I want," she repeated, her voice rising slightly. "This isn't me, Phil. I don't fantasize about other men. I don't come home soaking wet because some guy touched my hips."

"But you did," Phil said quietly.

She stared at him, her eyes glistening. "Yes."

"And you want him to touch you again."

"I..." She swallowed hard. "Yes."

Phil's cock throbbed. He shifted on the couch, trying to ignore it. "Do you want to sleep with him?"

Lydia's breath hitched. "I don't know. Maybe. God, what's wrong with me?"

"Nothing's wrong with you."

"I'm a married woman fantasizing about my riding instructor."

"So what?" Phil said. "You think I've never fantasized about other women?"

"That's different."

"How?"

She didn't answer.

Phil took her hand. "Listen to me. This doesn't make you a bad person. It doesn't make you a slut or whatever else you're telling yourself right now."

"Then what does it make me?"

"Human." He squeezed her fingers. "You're allowed to be attracted to someone else."

"But I'm married to you."

"And I'm sitting here with the hardest erection I've had in months listening to you talk about another man," Phil said bluntly.

Lydia's eyes dropped to his lap, where the bulge in his sweatpants was obvious. "You're turned on by this?"

"Apparently, yes."

She shook her head and looked away. "I don't even know how I would start this," she muttered.

"Start what?" he asked.

"I don't know how I would broach this subject with him. With Obinna, I mean. I don't even know if I can bring myself to look at him again. That was humiliating what happened at the arena."

Her phone buzzed in her jacket pocket. She reached in and pulled it out, then shook her head and set it down on the couch.

"Who is it?" Phil asked.

"It's them. Heavenly Hills. I can't answer that right now," she said.

He glanced down at the glowing screen and before he knew what he was doing, picked it up and swiped with his thumb to answer the call.

"What are you doing?!?" Lydia hissed.

"Hello?"

A short silence. "Um, hello," a woman's voice replied. "I was actually hoping to speak with Lydia? My name's Ellen. I'm her riding instructor."

He pulled the phone away from his ear and held it out for her to take. "It's Ellen," he said, excitement swelling in his chest.

Chapter Eleven

"Are we too formal? I feel like we're too formal," Lydia said, glancing down at her outfit.

They were standing at the front door of Obinna's house on the farm property.

"I feel like we're just about right?" Phil replied.

Lydia wore dark jeans that fit snug around her hips and thighs, the denim hugging the curve of her ass without being overly tight. A cream-colored blouse with three-quarter sleeves draped nicely over her chest, the fabric just fitted enough to show her shape without clinging. She'd left the top two buttons undone, revealing a hint of collarbone.

She'd waffled between nervous and excited all week. Phil could see that apprehension about seeing Obinna again after the incident was stressing her out.

Ellen had called to try and make amends and to invite them on behalf of Obinna, who didn't want to embarrass Lydia by calling himself.

Lydia had said no at first.

Phil had talked her into it. Slowly, carefully. He'd convinced her that confronting her shame would be good for her. He hadn't made mention of the fact that she still had seven lessons he'd paid for.

He felt a secret shame at enjoying her discomfort. It was so atypical of her to be unsettled by anything. It made her seem younger, more inexperienced. Like he was looking back at a past Lydia who was less world-weary.

The door opened and they both turned and smiled.

Lydia's smile faded when she saw the woman standing in front of them. "Ellen?" she said. "What are you doing here?"

Ellen laughed, grabbed Lydia's wrist and pulled her into the house. She turned and offered her hand to Phil. "I'm Ellen," she said.

Ellen was stunning. In her late twenties, blonde hair pulled into a loose ponytail that draped over one shoulder. Her skin had that golden tan of someone who spent most days outdoors. She wore a fitted burgundy sweater dress that ended mid-thigh, the knit fabric clinging to her lovely curves. Black tights covered her legs, disappearing into ankle boots.

"You're just as handsome as Lydia described," Ellen said, her blue eyes holding Phil's a beat longer than necessary. Her fingers lingered on his when she took his jacket.

Phil felt heat creep up his neck.

Motion caught his eye and he looked over Ellen's shoulder.

Obinna was greeting Lydia in hushed tones. He had his hands clasped around hers and looked like he was confessing some very deep secrets.

She stood with a rigid back in front of him, her cheeks a bright red. The light jazz music drifting through the room obscured whatever he was saying to her.

Phil didn't need to hear any of it. What he saw told him everything he needed to know.

Phil watched Lydia's shoulders stay locked, her posture rigid as a statue. She held herself like she did in all difficult situations. Controlled, contained and bracing for disaster.

He'd never seen her this rattled by another person. Twenty-three years together and Phil had watched Lydia navigate hospital politics, demanding patients, life-and-death decisions. She never looked like this. Never looked so completely off-balance.

It turned him on somehow.

Obinna leaned in closer, still holding her hands. Said something Phil couldn't hear.

Lydia's jaw tightened. Her fingers twitched in Obinna's grip but she didn't pull away.

She wanted to pull away but she wasn't letting herself. He could see right through her.

Phil's pulse picked up. Heat spread through his chest and into his groin.

Obinna said something else and Lydia's mouth parted slightly. Phil caught the quick rise and fall of her chest.

Then her shoulders dropped. Just a fraction, but Phil saw it. The rigid line of her spine softened.

Obinna smiled at her. Not the polite smile he'd given Phil during their first meeting. This one reached his eyes, warm and genuine.

Lydia let out a soft laugh. Short and breathy, like she'd surprised herself.

The sound hit Phil in the gut.

Obinna looked up and caught Phil's eye. He lifted one hand from Lydia's, keeping the other wrapped around her fingers, and waved them over.

"Come," Obinna said, smiling at him. "Please come inside."

Ellen touched Phil's elbow and nudged him further into the house.

Lydia glanced at him and her eyes widened slightly. Like she'd forgotten he was there. Like for a moment, Obinna had been the only person in the room.

Phil's cock thickened in his jeans.

Obinna held a hand out to Phil.

Phil gripped Obinna's hand and shook, reminded of just how strong his grip was.

Obinna smiled at him.

"Now that we're past that slightly awkward reintroduction," Obinna said, moving toward a sideboard where several wine bottles stood uncorked, "we should have some drinks."

He began pouring white wine into the four glasses arranged next to the bottles.

Lydia shifted her weight. "I didn't realize you two were..." She looked between Ellen and Obinna, her brow furrowing. "Are you two a couple?"

Phil glanced at Ellen, then back at Obinna. The question had been nagging at him too since Ellen had opened the door.

Ellen's laugh came light and easy. She accepted her wine from Obinna and took a sip before answering. "We don't really have an agenda. We just hang out sometimes."

Obinna handed Lydia the last glass. Their fingers brushed and Lydia's cheeks flushed again.

"To new experiences," Obinna said, raising his glass.

The three of them lifted their glasses in response. Phil drank and the wine was crisp and cold on his tongue. The alcohol soon heated his face hotter.

"Hors d'oeuvres will be ready in a moment," Obinna said. He set his glass down and turned to Lydia. "Would you join me in the kitchen? I could use an extra pair of hands."

Lydia blinked and looked at Phil, as if seeking reassurance.

Phil nodded.

"Of course," Lydia said.

Obinna placed a hand on the small of her back and guided her toward the doorway that led deeper into the house. Lydia glanced over her shoulder once at Phil before disappearing around the corner.

Phil found himself alone with Ellen.

The room felt smaller suddenly. The jazz music seemed louder, filling the silence between them.

Ellen moved to the couch and sat, crossing her legs. The hem of her dress rode up slightly on her thighs. She patted the cushion beside her.

"Sit," she said. "You look like you're about to bolt."

Phil forced a laugh and sat, leaving a respectful distance between them. He took another drink of wine.

"You're nervous," Ellen said. Not a question.

"A little," Phil admitted.

"Don't be." Ellen angled toward him, resting her elbow on the back of the couch. "Obinna likes you. He wouldn't have invited you if he didn't."

"What exactly is this?" Phil asked. The question came out before he could stop it.

Ellen tilted her head. "Dinner. Conversation. Whatever happens."

"That's not an answer."

"No," Ellen agreed, her smile widening. "It's not."

From the kitchen came the sound of Lydia's voice, low and indistinct. Then Obinna's laugh, deep and rich.

Phil's grip tightened on his glass.

Ellen leaned closer. Close enough that Phil caught her scent. Something floral and warm and feminine. "You're going to be okay," she said softly. "I promise."

His eyes dropped to her lips and, for a moment, he was gripped with the urge to kiss her. She was a gorgeous woman and flirting like she wanted to sleep with him.

As his face heated again he leaned away, struggling to resist the urge. He hadn't expected to see her there this evening. A question that had been nagging him all week floated to the top of his mind.

"Hey, can I ask you something?"

"Sure thing," Ellen said, smiling at him.

Phil glanced at her lips again. They were full and lovely and coated in a bright red lipstick that drew the eye. He found himself unable to look away.

Her smile widened. "Who knows?" she said. "Maybe later?"

Excitement spread through his chest.

"What were you going to ask?" Ellen prompted.

"I'm sure this is just some misunderstanding. But Ellen told me that you told her that I gave Obinna...that I told him he could..."

Ellen bit down on one corner of her mouth and looked theatrically up at the ceiling.

"Why?" Phil asked.

Ellen turned her eyes towards him again. "I thought she needed some help," she said.

"Help?" Phil asked.

"A nudge in the right direction. I know her type. We get them in here all the time. Middle aged and uptight but definitely curious," she said.

"Curious about what?"

Ellen's smile faded, drawing his eyes to her lips again. "Curious about what it's like riding a black man's dick."

A ringing started in Phil's ears. He'd never heard anyone say something so vulgar so casually before.

His reaction inspired another smile to form on Ellen's mouth. The look she gave him riveted him to his seat on the sofa.

He heard Lydia's laugh puncture the smooth jazz drifting through the room. The sound sank deep into his groin.

"Oh you're going to make such a good little cuck," Ellen whispered.

He looked down at his arm when he felt her fingers brush against it. He genuinely felt like he couldn't have moved even if he tried. "What is going on here?" he whispered.

Ellen leaned towards him. So close he could smell the wine on her lips. "We're all going to have some snacks. Then Obinna is going to seduce that pretty wife of yours while we watch," she explained. "Does that sound like fun?"

His mouth opened but no sound came out. His eyes moved between hers and the curve of her lips. He felt a pull towards her, like she was casting a spell over him with her dirty talk. "Why are you here?" he asked her.

She lifted her hand and gently dragged the backs of her fingers along his jaw. "Obinna likes to have me around for first times."

The sound of Lydia's gentle laughter finally tore his attention away from Ellen and towards the entrance to the kitchen.

Lydia emerged from the kitchen carrying a wooden tray laden with small appetizers. Crackers topped with cheese and what looked to be smoked salmon.

Obinna came out behind her.

Lydia's eyes found Phil and Ellen on the couch. Her brow furrowed slightly.

Phil became immediately aware of how close Ellen sat to him. How Ellen's hand rested on the back of the couch near his shoulder.

Lydia walked to the coffee table and bent to set down the tray. The movement pulled her jeans tight across her ass.

Phil watched Obinna's eyes drop to Lydia's backside, then flick up to meet Phil's gaze. No shame in the look whatsoever. "It's good you two are getting to know each other," he said.

Lydia stood from the table. Before she could turn fully, Obinna's hands landed on her shoulders.

She froze.

Obinna turned her to face him. His large hands stayed on her shoulders, thumbs resting against her collarbones.

Lydia looked up at him. Her chest rose and fell in quick succession.

Obinna gazed down at her. The room went quiet except for the jazz music still playing softly in the background.

The edges of Phil's vision blurred, his focus narrowing on Lydia.

A moment of excruciating tension passed. Lydia looked terrified.

Then Obinna leaned down.

Lydia's eyes fluttered shut and her lips parted.

Obinna kissed her. Slow and deliberately, his mouth pressing against hers.

Lydia's hands came up, hovering near Obinna's chest. Not pushing him away. Not pulling him closer. Just suspended there, uncertain.

The kiss lasted several seconds. Long enough for Phil to watch his wife's shoulders relax. Long enough for her fingers to curl against Obinna's shirt.

When Obinna pulled back, Lydia's eyes stayed closed for a beat longer. Then they opened, wide and dazed.

"You've been on my mind all week," Obinna said, his voice low.

Lydia swallowed. "I..." She glanced at Phil. Color flooded her cheeks. "We should probably..."

"No rush," Obinna said. He released her shoulders but kept his eyes on her face. "We have all evening."

Ellen shifted on the couch beside Phil. Her hand dropped to Phil's thigh, fingers spreading against the denim.

Phil looked down at her hand, then back up at his wife standing in another man's arms.

Chapter Twelve

Lydia's face burned. She could feel the heat crawling up her neck and spreading across her cheeks.

Obinna's whispered greeting had been so tactful and polite. Reassuring her that she had nothing to be ashamed of and to act like it had never happened.

But it had happened. And all of the people gathered here knew it had happened. There was no hiding from that.

And now Obinna had kissed her right in front of her husband and her head was spinning and she had no idea what to say or do next.

"What do you think, Phil?" Obinna asked, turning to look at Phil.

"W-what do I think?" Phil stammered. "What do I think about what?"

Obinna eyed him for a few moments. "I just kissed your wife. Do you have something to say about that?"

Phil just gawked at the two of them. His mouth hung open and his eyes were wide.

Ellen stared at him with a playful smile.

When Phil said nothing, Obinna left the question hanging. He turned his head and gazed deep into Lydia's eyes with a look that made her knees go weak.

She felt so out of control of the situation yet completely safe with his hands on her shoulders. Like there was nothing that could go wrong. "I liked it," she whispered.

Words that never would have left her lips if Obinna hadn't just kissed her so deeply and intensely.

"I'm so very glad to hear that," Obinna said.

He leaned in and pressed his lips against hers.

Her mouth parted and she accepted his probing tongue, pressing back against it with her own.

The kiss was more demanding than the last. The first one had been gentle and probing. This one felt like she was being claimed as his for the evening. Right in front of her husband.

The thought made her sex wet and clench slightly.

Her eyes had closed again and she let herself slip into unashamed excitement at Obinna kissing her with Phil sitting right there.

And it was exciting. She, who worked so carefully to control everything about her life, was having the sorts of feelings she remembered from so long ago. The youthful of the world coming at her at full volume.

The thrill of the taste of a new lover.

Her fingers moved along his arms, tracing the defined muscles beneath the fabric of his shirt. His mouth moved against hers with almost perfect rhythm, like they'd done this a thousand times before. Like a horse and rider in sync, she thought, and the comparison sent a fresh wave of heat through her belly and down between her legs.

His tongue slid against hers, firm and confident.

It was different from Phil's. Phil kissed her gently. Carefully, like he was always asking permission. Obinna kissed her like he already knew the answer.

She hadn't kissed anyone this way in over twenty years. The realization thrilled her and made her heart pound harder in her chest.

Her hands travelled up to his shoulders. They were broad and solid under her palms. Then she trailed them down his chest.

She could feel the hard planes of muscle through his shirt, the warmth of his skin radiating through the cotton. Her fingers moved lower, over his abdomen, feeling the ridges of corded muscle. Muscle packed with power.

He was enormous. Not just tall but built. Thick and strong. The sort of physique young women fantasize being overpowered by.

The image flashed through her mind. Her body pressed down into a mattress, Obinna's weight on top of her, holding her there. Her pussy clenched again and this time began to ache with need.

Obinna pulled back slowly, ending the kiss. His hands remained on her shoulders, steadying her. "Better?" he asked quietly.

She nodded, not trusting her voice.

"Good." He squeezed her shoulders gently before releasing her and stepping back.

Obinna guided her around the couch, one hand firm on her lower back. She moved where he directed her, settling onto the perpendicular section of the L-shaped sofa.

From here she had a clear view of Phil.

Her husband sat frozen, his eyes locked on her. His pupils were dilated and his breathing was shallow. She could see the bulge in his jeans. His

thickening cock straining against the fabric.

Ellen sat close beside him. Too close. Her hand still rested on his thigh, fingers splayed possessively.

A flicker of irritation sparked in Lydia's chest. She didn't want Ellen touching Phil. This wasn't supposed to be about that. This was about her and Obinna and...

Obinna's hand cupped her jaw, turning her face toward him.

"Look at me," he said quietly.

She obeyed.

He leaned in and captured her mouth again. This kiss was different still from the others. Slower. Deeper. His tongue slid against hers with long strokes and she responded without thinking, again matching his rhythm.

Her hands found his chest again. The solid warmth of him beneath her palms made her pulse quicken.

His hand moved from her jaw to the back of her neck, fingers threading through her hair. The other hand settled on her hip, thumb stroking small circles through the fabric of her slacks.

She melted into him.

The kiss went on. His mouth worked hers with a patience that made her dizzy. She'd forgotten what it felt like to be kissed like this. To have someone take their time with her body.

His hand on her hip slid upward, grazing the side of her breast through her blouse.

Her nipple hardened.

She gasped against his mouth.

His palm cupped her breast fully now, thumb brushing over the stiff bud. Even through her bra the sensation shot straight to her belly. The room felt

stifling.

Obinna's fingers found the hem of her blouse and he tugged it free from her slacks. Cool air hit her waist for a moment before his hand slipped underneath, his palm pressing against her bare skin.

She shivered.

His hand was huge. Rough. Callused from work. It moved across her stomach, over her ribs, tracing the line of her body in slow exploration.

Her breathing came faster now. She could feel her chest rising and falling against him.

His thumb grazed the underside of her breast, just beneath the wire of her bra.

A breathy sound escaped her. Needy and desperate and not to her liking.

He pulled back from the kiss, his hand still resting on her bare skin beneath her blouse.

Her lips felt swollen. Her whole body hummed with heat.

Obinna turned his head toward Phil.

"What do you think, Phil?" His voice was calm and measured. Like he was asking about the weather.

Lydia's eyes snapped to her husband.

Phil stared at them, mouth slightly open. His chest rose and fell with his breathing. The bulge in his jeans looked fully formed now, straining hard against the denim.

Ellen's hand had moved higher on his thigh, fingers dangerously close to his crotch.

Lydia's stomach twisted. She didn't like seeing Ellen so close to him. Touching him.

But Obinna's hand moved on her skin, drawing her attention back. His thumb stroked along her ribs, a gentle reminder of where she was. Of what was happening.

Phil swallowed hard. His voice came out hoarse. "I think..." He cleared his throat. "I think she's enjoying herself."

Each time Obinna kissed Lydia, Phil's vision tunnelled on how their lips came together. He couldn't believe how erotic it was seeing Lydia kiss another man.

He felt a twinge of guilt at the fact that, somehow, Obinna's blackness turned him on. There was something arousing about it. The way the dark skin on the back of his hand made Lydia's cheeks seem even whiter when he touched it.

Phil's breath caught as Obinna's hand slid from Lydia's shoulder down to her waist. The movement seemed deliberate and slow enough that Phil couldn't look away.

Obinna's palm settled on Lydia's hip. His thumb traced a small circle through the fabric of her skirt.

Phil's cock throbbed in his pants. He shifted his weight, acutely aware of how obvious his erection must be.

Ellen sat right beside him. She had to be able to see it. The thought sent heat crawling up his neck.

"You're tense," Obinna said to Lydia.

His hand moved higher, cupping her breast through her blouse. Lydia gasped. The sound went straight to Phil's groin.

Phil watched Obinna's dark fingers knead the pale fabric covering Lydia's breast. The contrast made everything sharper somehow. More vivid. He felt a twinge of guilt for being turned on by it, but he couldn't stop staring.

Obinna's other hand found the hem of Lydia's blouse. He tugged it free from her jeans, exposing a strip of her stomach. Then his hand disappeared beneath the fabric, sliding up her skin.

Lydia's eyes fluttered shut. Her lips parted.

Phil's erection pressed painfully against his zipper. He wanted to adjust himself but couldn't move. Ellen's hand still rested on his thigh, her fingers warm through his pants.

Obinna worked the buttons of Lydia's blouse open one by one. Phil counted each one. Five buttons. When the last one came free, Obinna eased the blouse off Lydia's shoulders and down her arms.

She sat there in her bra. White lace Phil had seen a hundred times before, but never like this. Never with another man's hands on her.

"What do you think, Phil?"

Obinna's voice cut through the fog in Phil's head. He looked up and found Lydia staring at him. Her cheeks flushed pink. Her pupils dilated.

"She looks beautiful," Phil said. His voice came out rough.

Lydia's blush deepened.

Obinna reached behind her. Phil heard the soft click of her bra clasp releasing.

"Oh god." Lydia's hands came up, clutching the cups of her bra to her chest. She looked horrified, like she'd suddenly had a change of heart at hearing the sound. "I don't know if I can do this." Her eyes darted from Obinna to Phil and back.

Ellen moved fast. She shifted on the couch, sliding behind Lydia until Lydia sat between her legs. Ellen's arms wrapped around Lydia's shoulders.

"Everything's alright," Ellen murmured against Lydia's ear. "I'm right here. I'm going to help you."

Phil watched Ellen's hands cover Lydia's. Their fingers intertwined. Then Ellen gently pulled Lydia's hands away from her chest. The bra slipped down.

Ellen caught it, tossed it aside. Then her lips found the side of Lydia's neck.

Lydia's breasts were exposed. Phil had seen them thousands of times, but never in front of anyone else. Never while another woman kissed his wife's neck and another man reached for her.

Obinna's hand cupped Lydia's bare breast. His dark fingers against her pale skin made Phil's skin prickle. He squeezed gently.

Lydia moaned and seemed to slide back into the trance-like state she'd been in kissing Obinna.

Phil's cock throbbed in his pants. He sat there, frozen, watching his wife respond to another man's touch while Ellen held her from behind. All he could do was watch as Obinna leaned in and kissed Lydia again, his hand still kneading her breast.

Jealousy bloomed in Phil's chest like a poisonous flower.

It wasn't clean or simple. Not the straightforward anger of a man whose wife was being touched by a stranger. This jealousy twisted through him in ways he had no name for. Hot and sick and thrilling all at once.

He should stop this. Any normal husband would. Any real man would stand up, pull Lydia away, tell Obinna to get his hands off her.

But Phil sat frozen on the couch, his erection straining against his zipper, watching Obinna's mouth close around Lydia's nipple.

The sound Lydia made, a whimper that rose from deep in her throat, shot straight to Phil's groin. He'd never heard her make that sound before. Not in twenty-three years of marriage.

Obinna's tongue circled her nipple. His dark cheek pressed against the pale swell of her breast. Then he moved to the other side, pulling the second nipple between his lips.

Phil's hands clenched on his knees. The jealousy writhed in his gut, mixing with arousal until he couldn't separate the two. He was hard enough to hurt. Watching his wife respond to another man's mouth. Hating it and craving it simultaneously.

Ellen shifted behind Lydia, one hand sliding up to cup Lydia's jaw. She turned Lydia's face toward her and kissed her. Slow and deep.

There was a soothing gentleness in seeing that. He'd never seen Lydia kiss another woman in such a sexual way. Ellen's femininity somehow diffused Obinna's masculine, probing hunger.

Obinna's hands moved to Lydia's waist. His fingers found the button of her jeans and popped it open. The rasp of her zipper cut through the smooth jazz.

Lydia moaned into Ellen's mouth.

The jealousy flared hotter inside him. Some primitive part of his brain blared at him that he should do something. Assert himself. Reclaim his wife.

But his cock throbbed with each beat of his heart, and he couldn't move.

Obinna hooked his fingers in the waistband of Lydia's jeans. He tugged them down over her hips. Lydia lifted slightly, helping him, still kissing

Ellen.

The jeans came off. Then Lydia sat there in nothing but her white cotton underwear with Ellen's arms around her and Obinna kneeling between her legs.

Phil's breathing came shallow and fast. His wife. His meticulous, controlled wife. Half-naked on another man's couch, being kissed by a woman while that man's dark hands slid up her pale thighs.

The contrast kept catching Phil's eye. Obinna's skin against Lydia's. Dark and light. It shouldn't matter. Phil knew it shouldn't matter. But it added another layer to the jealousy, another dimension to his arousal that made him feel ashamed and desperately excited at the same time.

What kind of man got turned on watching this? What kind of husband sat there with his cock hard while another man seduced his wife?

Obinna's fingers traced the edge of Lydia's underwear. Just the barest touch along the elastic at her hip.

Lydia broke the kiss with Ellen. Her head fell back against Ellen's shoulder. Her eyes settled on Phil across the room and bugged, like she'd once again forgotten he was there. "Oh god," she whispered. "Phil."

Chapter Thirteen

Looking at Phil felt like staring back in time. Like looking at an old album of what her life used to be like. It was deeply disquieting.

He looked so helpless and almost frail sitting there immobile on the couch. Like they were staring at each other through the event horizon of a black hole.

"It's okay. He's fine."

Ellen's whispered reassurance made the skin on the back of her neck prickle.

Suddenly she was wrenched from the sensory experience of hands and mouths on her body, into the harsh reality that she was copulating with two strangers while her husband stared at her from across the room.

Ellen's appearance behind her had calmed her greatly. When Obinna had unclasped her bra she'd been thrown into shock. Unable to reconcile what was happening with the woman she believed herself to be.

Now Ellen's gentle touches and whispers were doing the same thing. Staring straight into Phil's wide eyes had wrenched her from savouring the

pleasure of Ellen and Obinna's touches and cast her into the front of her mind.

Into the rational, calculating, judgmental part of her brain that had seemed to smack her across the face and demand what it was, exactly, that was happening here?

Ellen coddled her, caressing her arm and easing her back into the pleasure centre where she could once again try to enjoy what was happening.

"See?" Ellen whispered. "He's fine. Tell her you're fine, Phil."

Phil blinked a few times, then nodded. "I-I'm fine," he stammered. "You look beautiful right now."

Beautiful? He really thought she looked beautiful sandwiched between these two bodies? Obinna on his knees in front of her, gently spreading her thighs.

Obinna on his knees in front of her?!? Gently spreading her thighs?!?

Her jaw dropped and she balked at what was happening. Only a thin layer of cotton protected her most intimate spot from Obinna's probing gaze and wandering hands.

Obinna's fingers traced lazy circles on her inner thighs, each touch sending sparks straight to her exposed pussy. The heat pooling between her legs turned to a throbbing ache that made rational thought slip further away.

Am I really going to let Phil watch another man eat me out?

The deliberately crude phrasing shocked her and cut through the sexy haze like a scalpel. But instead of sobering her, it ignited something darker inside her.

Am I really going to let Obinna eat my pussy while Phil watches?

She teased herself with the thought, excitement building the closer it got to reality.

Ellen's lips found the sensitive spot below her ear. "Just relax," she murmured. "Let him make you feel good."

Obinna's thumbs stroked the crease where her thigh met her pelvis, deliberate and maddeningly close. His breath warmed her through the thin cotton, and Lydia's hips twitched involuntarily.

"Please," she whispered, not entirely sure what she was begging for.

Obinna hooked his fingers into the waistband of her panties. The elastic stretched and pulled, then began its descent down her trembling legs. Warm air hit her exposed pussy and she gasped, instinctively trying to close her thighs.

"Be calm, beautiful." Obinna's deep voice rumbled through her. His hands pressed her knees apart. "Let me see you."

Ellen's hands were everywhere now. Cupping her breasts, thumbs circling her nipples until they stood absolutely rigid. Soft kisses trailed down her neck. The dual assault on her senses jumbled her thoughts, forcing her to surrender to the arousal centre in her mind.

Obinna's gaze fixed on the neatly trimmed hair between her legs. He widened her thighs further, settling his broad shoulders between them.

Lydia arched her back, Ellen supporting her weight from behind. The position opened her completely, vulnerable and exposed in a way that should have terrified her.

Across the room, Phil shifted. She caught the movement in her peripheral vision but couldn't bring herself to look at him. Couldn't face what she might see in his eyes.

Obinna's mouth descended, and that first gentle pass of his tongue along her seam brought a warbling cry from her throat.

Ellen dragged her lips along her neck.

Obinna's tongue traced her folds slowly, as if learning the shape of them.

Ellen's hands cupped her breasts and kneaded them in rhythm with Obinna's exploration, her mouth hot against Lydia's neck.

Another stroke, firmer this time, and Lydia's hips bucked. Obinna gripped her thighs, held her steady as his tongue found her clit. The direct contact sent electricity sparking through every nerve there.

"That's it," Ellen murmured against her skin. "Let go, Lydia. Just feel it."

Obinna's tongue circled, flicked, then dipped lower and pressed into her opening.

The moan that elicited sounded like she might start crying.

Each new sight and each new sound engorged his sensory experience until his brain felt so full he thought he might burst.

Phil's chest tightened as Obinna's head moved between Lydia's thighs, the wet sounds of his tongue were so obscene against the soundtrack of the smooth jazz.

Each lick, each deliberate stroke, sent a fresh wave of heat through Phil's body. Part arousal and part jealous anger at seeing her so open, so vulnerable.

His wife. His Lydia. Spread open on another man's couch as he feasted on her pussy.

He rolled that thought over and over in his mind, savouring its depravity.

The indignity of it should have crushed him. Lydia. Surgeon, wife and mother who never came to be without her moisturizer splayed out on this stranger's couch having her pussy feasted on while her husband watched.

That woman now writhed against Ellen's hands, her head thrown back, lips parted in mindless pleasure.

They looked like animals.

It was the mindlessness of it that tickled him darkly. The way Obinna and Ellen were able to coax her to lose herself inside herself. It gnawed at him and he didn't know why.

Obinna's dark fingers spread Lydia's pale thighs wider, and Phil's cock again throbbed painfully against his zipper. The contrast burned into his retinas. Lydia's milky skin against Obinna's rich brown hands. The way her pink folds glistened with arousal and saliva.

Another wet slurp. Phil flinched.

Obinna's tongue traced the full length of Lydia's groove before circling her clit.

Her hips jerked forward, seeking more, and shame flooded Phil's chest even as his hand drifted toward his crotch.

Ellen whispered something into Lydia's ear as she rolled her nipples between her fingers.

Lydia whimpered, then arched her back. Offering herself more fully to Obinna's mouth.

Phil's hand froze halfway to his erection.

It shouldn't have been a shock that she never moved like that for him. Never surrendered so completely.

They'd been married more than twenty years and for that amount of time they were doing *just fine*. In the bedroom and everywhere else.

But seeing her like this now, seeing how much sexual potential was still stored inside her body, made his cock throb and his heart sing with love and a strange melancholy sadness.

Obinna pressed his middle finger against Lydia's entrance, still sucking her clit, and Phil watched that dark digit sink into his wife's body.

A sound burbled up from his throat. A half groan and half whimper that embarrassed him.

The sight paralyzed him. Obinna's black finger disappearing into Lydia's pale pink folds, her inner walls gripping him, her wetness coating his knuckle as he worked deeper. The visual seared itself into Phil's mind. Dark and light, possession and surrender, his wife taking another man inside her. A black man inside her.

Obinna added a second finger, stretching Lydia open while his tongue continued its gentle massage of her clit.

Lydia cried out and her hands flew to Ellen's thighs for support as her hips rolled against Obinna's face.

Phil's cock strained against his pants. It was so hard and hurt so good. His hand finally closed over it through the fabric, squeezing, but it wasn't enough. Nothing would be enough except burying himself inside her when she was his to have again.

Obinna's fingers pumped faster, curling inside Lydia as he stroked her.

Her thighs trembled, muscles tensing, and Phil recognized the signs. She was close. She was close to having her first orgasm by this strange man's mouth and hand.

Ellen's hands slid down Lydia's torso, one settling on her hip while the other traced circles on her lower belly. Encouraging. Guiding.

"That's it," Ellen murmured. "Let him make you come."

Phil's grip tightened on his own erection. His breath came in shallow gasps as he watched Obinna devour his wife, watched those dark fingers

disappear again and again into Lydia's body, watched her surrender everything to him.

The jealousy burned hot enough to choke him.

The arousal burned hotter.

Lydia's legs kicked out wildly, heels drumming against the cushions as her back arched off the couch and away from Ellen's grasp. Her cry tore through the room and it was nothing like the careful sounds she made in their bedroom.

Phil's mouth went dry.

A trickle of clear fluid leaked from between her thighs, dampening the couch beneath her.

His brain stuttered over the sight. Was she...had she just...

Squirted?

On Obinna's couch. His pristine wife who always showered immediately after sex, who insisted on towels beneath them, had just squirted like some porn star?

It wasn't some huge gusher but something had definitely emitted from her as her climax started.

Obinna didn't slow. His tongue maintained the relentless pressure on her clit while his fingers curved inside her, stroking something deep that made her whole body convulse.

Ellen's hands glided across Lydia's trembling stomach, up to cup her breasts, then down again to her hips. Soothing and possessive and reassuring all at the same time.

"Yes," Ellen whispered against Lydia's ear. "Give it all to him."

Another wave crashed through Lydia. Her thighs clamped around Obinna's head before flying open again, no control left in her limbs. The

wail that escaped her throat pitched higher, desperate, as another gush of wetness soaked the cushions.

Phil's hand worked his cock through his pants, trying to squeeze out some of the pressure without letting it release completely. The sight of his composed, meticulous wife completely undone, her body wrung out by another man's mouth, sent electricity crackling down his spine.

Lydia's thighs began to shake violently, muscles spasming beyond her control. Her hands pushed weakly at Obinna's shoulders.

"Stop...I can't...please, I can't take any more..."

Obinna lifted his head, lips glistening with her arousal, and delivered three more slow, deliberate licks along her slit. Lydia whimpered at each one, her hips twitching involuntarily.

Then he stood, rising to his full height above her sprawled form.

Lydia stared up at him through half-lidded eyes, her chest heaving, body slack against Ellen like a rag doll.

Without a word, Obinna reached down and pressed two fingers, the same ones that had been buried inside her, against Lydia's mouth.

Her tongue emerged, lazy and pink, sliding across his dark skin. She looked up at him through those exhausted eyes while she licked, cleaning her own wetness from his fingers with slow but deliberate laps of her tongue. She showed no embarrassment or protest.

She looked hypnotized. Drugged on the pleasure he'd just given her.

Obinna withdrew his fingers and offered them to Ellen. She opened her mouth eagerly, sucking them clean with theatrical enthusiasm, her eyes locked on his, searching for approval.

The clink of a belt buckle made Phil blink.

Obinna's hands worked at his waist, the leather sliding free, zipper lowering. He turned his head toward Phil, a knowing smile playing at his lips.

"Does your wife like to suck on cock?"

Chapter Fourteen

Phil stared at Obinna, his jaw moving up and down but no sound coming out. He furrowed his brow, trying to make sense of what he'd just been asked.

"Oh stop it!"

Ellen's voice shook him from his trance. His eyes trailed down to see her rolling her eyes and shaking her head. "He's just teasing," she said, chuckling.

When he looked up at Obinna, he was laughing, too. Not uproariously, just softly chuckling, amused at being in charge of whatever game it was they were playing here.

He drew his cock out wordlessly and let it sag against his thighs.

Phil's gaze sagged to it, unbidden. It took his mind many seconds to encompass and catalogue what it was he was looking at.

He'd seen a few before. Shrivelled, long, lean and thick. Erect in porn. He tried to think if he'd seen another man's erection in real life? He hadn't. He'd seen them at the gym. Uncut, circumcised, some wiry, some shrunken.

What he was looking at now did not fit in the same category as any of those. What he was looking at now brought to mind animals.

Horses. Elephants. Donkeys.

He wasn't startled by Obinna stepping out of his pants and continuing to disrobe in front of him because he was still trying to encapsulate, to fully grasp that he was looking at a human male's reproductive organ.

Does your wife like to suck on cock?

Now he chuckled. An awkward sound that spilled out of him and drew the attention of both Ellen and Obinna.

They turned and looked at him and both began to laugh.

"I think he gets it now," Obinna said.

Phil had no idea what he was talking about. But he definitely felt like he was closer to being in on the joke.

Ellen cupped Lydia's breasts, then gently tweaked her nipples.

Lydia drew in a breath and stirred, her eyes coming to life.

Obinna lazily stepped around the couch as he undid the buttons of his shirt. He came to a stop behind it, with Ellen and Lydia in front of him and the backrest between them.

He shamelessly wrapped his hand around his cock, hoisted it and let it settle on the backrest pillows.

Even flaccid, it was an imposing thing.

Lydia blinked her eyes.

Ellen bit down on her lip, like she was excited about the next part of the evening.

Phil let out a sigh and squeezed his cock with his hand.

"You beautiful thing," Obinna murmured. He reached out and let his fingers graze Lydia's shoulder.

The touch seemed to bring her a situational awareness she wasn't ready for. She stirred and one arm rose to cover her breasts. Her other hand fell between her legs and her cheeks flushed red and hot.

Her eyes darted to the cock and then hot shame welled through her, evidenced by an even redder face and neck and chest. She curled her body, trying to hide her naked vulnerability from everyone.

"Shh," Ellen whispered. "It's okay. Everything's fine. We're all just having fun."

Obinna bent over her and wrapped his thick fingers around her wrist, then drew her hand up and over his prick before letting it settle on it.

She looked like a skittish horse and he treated her like one. Giving her the soothing, reassuring comfort of touching something she could be certain wouldn't harm her.

She settled almost instantly, the nervous energy leaving her body. She regarded her dainty hand plastered over that obscene phallus and seemed to contemplate something very profound.

Obinna caressed the back of her hand with the backs of his fingers. He turned his palm down and closed his hand around hers, wrapping those fingers tight around his prick.

She gulped and her eyes shot sideways but Phil could see the apprehension was put on now. Now it was just an act. For him. Or for herself, perhaps? Still needing to play the woman she thought she *ought* to be.

It was more riveting than any live theatre he'd ever seen.

"Just give it a gentle touch, would you?" Obinna asked.

Ellen's hands remained on Lydia's shoulders, gentle and reassuring. Her whispers were too soft for Phil to catch, but he watched their effect. The

way Lydia's grip tightened, how her thumb swept experimentally along the underside of Obinna's shaft.

The organ responded. Slowly at first, then with gathering momentum. It thickened in her palm, lengthening as blood filled it. Lydia's eyes widened. Her lips parted as she watched the transformation occur beneath her touch.

"That's it," Obinna murmured. "Just like that."

Lydia seemed to forget where she was. Her strokes became more confident. Her fingers explored the ridges and veins that stood out against the darkening skin. She tilted her head, studying it from different angles.

Ellen kissed Lydia's temple. "Beautiful, isn't it?"

Lydia nodded. Her gaze remained on Obinna's cock as it rose to full hardness. The thing jutted forward now, obscene and demanding. Dwarfing her pale hand wrapped around its centre.

Obinna's hand came down, his dark fingers caressing Lydia's cheek with surprising tenderness. "Now. Would you take it in your mouth?"

The question hung in the air. Phil chewed on the inside of his mouth.

Lydia's eyes flicked up to Obinna's face, then across to Phil. The question in them was clear.

Is this really happening? Do you want this?

Phil found himself nodding. His throat felt too thick to speak.

That seemed to be all the permission Lydia needed. She turned back to Obinna's cock, still gripping it with one hand. Her other hand rose to join the first, both pale against that dark skin.

Ellen's fingers traced down Lydia's spine. "Take your time."

Lydia leaned forward. The movement was almost clinical. Methodical and precise, the way she worked. No seductive lowering of lashes, no coy

glances. Just Lydia approaching a new experience with the same careful attention she brought to everything she put her hands on.

Her mouth opened. Wide, like she was at the dentist. Like she was preparing for an examination rather than about to perform oral sex on another man's cock.

She paused there, frozen. Her breath misted against Obinna's tip. Her tongue appeared, wetting her lips.

Phil's hand tightened around his own cock.

Lydia's eyes fluttered half-closed. Her clinical expression softened into something dreamlike, that same trance-like state she'd entered when Obinna's mouth had been on her.

The head of Obinna's cock brushed against her lower lip.

She inhaled sharply through her nose.

Phil held his breath.

Finally, she moved her mouth forward and the head of Obinna's cock disappeared inside it. She closed her lips around it and held him there, as if uncertain of what to do next.

Obinna stared at her, Ellen still caressing her back, giving her tactile encouragement to continue.

Obinna's hand moved under her chin and cupped it. "Look up," he said. "Look up into my eyes."

Phil's eyes were bugged wide open. The sight of Lydia with that fat cock in her mouth had been enough to steal the breath from his lungs. Obinna's casual instructions were out of this world. Wildly out of Lydia's sexual experience.

The way her eyes darted side to side excited him so much. The skittishness returning to her demeanour, the fascination with the cock

suddenly lost when faced with the demand to meet its owners stare. That nervous energy filled her body again.

Her hands fell to the backrest and, for a moment, looked like she was going to push away. Pull her mouth off of that cock and put a firm stop to all of this.

Ellen swooped in behind her, one hand falling between Lydia's legs, the other brushing along her upper arm. Whispering encouragement and instruction. Telling her how good she was doing and how good Obinna was going to make her feel and how pretty that cock looked in her mouth.

Lydia's breath came quicker through her nostrils. In her eyes Phil could see the warring factions of her mind. The clinical surgeon who demanded order and hygiene and the status her station normally bestowed her. But what was on the other side?

What part of Lydia Ackerman was pushing back against that?

"I said look up," Obinna repeated.

An electric thrill shot down Phil's back.

No one talked to Dr. Lydia Ackerman like that. No one injected that sort of dark, demanding note into their tone when addressing her. Hell, no one demanded anything of her.

Perhaps Obinna didn't realize what line he'd just crossed, but Phil sure did. He braced for impact.

All of the muscles in his groin released and contracted in rhythm as he watched her eyelids flutter, then her eyes flutter up to meet Obinna's stare.

The look she gave him, a look of complete and utter submission to his will, softened her features in a way Phil had never seen before. She was fucking *begging* him with her eyes.

A slow and pleased smile spread across Obinna's mouth.

Ellen caressed and encouraged and whispered and kissed.

Obinna, with one hand still cupping her chin, put his other on the side of her face and smiled wider. "Now that's a good black cock slut," he purred.

Lydia let out a shuddering snort through her nose.

Phil suddenly felt twice as heavy, sinking deeper into the couch.

Lydia's eyes darted side to side. She looked like the poster girl for second thoughts.

"Eyes on me," Obinna demanded.

After a few more darts side to side she met his gaze again.

Obinna pulled her mouth and inch tighter onto his cock, then backed it off. The way he looked at her made it clear he didn't care who she was. To him, her mouth was just another fuck hole to be used, regardless of what was in her mind.

He continued the motion. In and back, in and back. Testing the shape of her oral cavity with his enormously hard cock.

He leaned over her and took his hand from the side of her face and brought it down onto her ass with a massive clap.

The sound made Phil jump.

Obinna stood up tall again and resumed fucking her face.

Lydia's eyes widened as she stared up at him.

Obinna leaned over her and repeated the motion, this time falling on her other cheek. He stood up and drew her in and back a few more times, then pulled his cock out of her mouth. "You suck cock the way you ride."

Phil thought his eyes were going to fall out of his face.

"Too prim and proper and not loose enough. But you'll learn, beautiful. You'll learn. What do you think of that?"

Lydia was breathing heavy through her open mouth now. Two large red spots had bloomed on her backside. She was still staring up at Obinna and seemed mostly unmoved by what he'd said.

Her nipples were pebble hard at the peaks of her breasts. Her pussy glistened with arousal.

Obinna ran his thick thumb along her lower lip. He bent at the waist and kissed her deeply on the mouth. After pulling away he looked into her eyes again. "What do you think of that?" he asked.

"I..." she began, then gasped.

Ellen's hand had fallen between Lydia's legs and she was rubbing up and down the line of her slit with a finger. Every few swipes she'd dip the finger into her pussy and hold it there a moment.

"I..."

Obinna nodded. "Just give in to it, Mrs. Ackerman."

"I want to be a good black cock slut."

Chapter Fifteen

She knew the biological mechanisms at play inside her body. How the over-stimulation of her sexual organs had flooded her brain with pleasure chemicals and temporarily lifted her inhibitions.

Those had returned as soon as the orgasm had passed and she'd felt so ashamed and vulnerable.

She understood, too, what Obinna's spanking had accomplished. A release of endorphins, natural pain killers that had contributed to the euphoria she was feeling now.

What she couldn't understand, and what she couldn't fit neatly into the equation was her own perverse fascination with his enormous black cock.

She'd had boyfriends before she married Phil but she'd never been an overly sexual woman. She enjoyed it when it happened, sure, but she didn't go seeking it out.

She didn't harbour any fascination with male genitalia outside of its limited uses for pleasure and reproduction. She didn't care what a man had as long as he was polite and interesting to talk to.

She'd heard plenty of locker room gossip about *size-queens* when she'd played lacrosse. That had all just sounded like a bunch of women clucking for a laugh.

So she could in no way understand the preoccupation she'd developed in an instant after seeing Obinna's cock.

Yes, it was large. No, not large. It was *fucking* huge.

It wasn't just that, though. It had been almost ugly when it was still soft. Just a wrinkly, lumpy tenderloin of meat.

She'd shuddered when Obinna had pressed her carefully manicured hand against it.

It was when it started hardening that her fascination had absorbed her. That a man could have a thing so big that grew *so much*.

The inevitable and obvious question had followed. Could she take a thing that size? A question she never in a million years would have asked herself if she hadn't seen it with her own eyes.

The feeling it inspired inside her seemed like a biological imperative too. Like her body was daring her, goading her to try and accommodate that sort of girth.

And from a biological perspective that sort of hypothesis would not be entirely unfounded. A cock that big would surely have belonged to a large specimen of male.

Back when these things mattered, large male specimens would have provided more and better protection than someone of shorter stature.

It stood to reason, too, that the seed from such a thing would not only be more potent but carry superior genetic information to mix with hers.

That last thought caused her head to spin like she'd had too much wine. The thought of receiving Obinna's genetic information made her wet

between the legs and completely unashamed.

A part of her had struggled against his dominating mouth-fuck. The part that had spent fifteen years in school to learn how to fix hearts.

A far more primal part of her had won that fight. When he'd demanded her attention and used her mouth like just another hole, she'd felt lines of wet leaking down the insides of her thighs.

Thankfully she'd just been brought to a humiliating squirting orgasm in front of her husband and didn't feel the need justify her sex leaking from taking that dark organ into her mouth.

When Obinna had told her that she sucked cock like she rode she could have slapped him. Thing was, deep down she knew he was right. She'd never been the kind of woman desperate to please a man with her mouth.

She didn't even care that much about pleasing *him* right now.

What had made her utter those horrifying words, *I want to be a good black cock slut*, had been the promise of knowing what it would feel like having that enormous fucking organ lodged inside her.

Not just lodged so tight she couldn't move but spewing out the life-creating juices from his balls deep into her body.

She'd never craved anything sexually the way she craved that right now.

She wanted it so bad that no amount of shame or embarrassment or humiliation was going to keep her from it. From knowing how that felt.

There was Phil, sitting on the couch and looking on with his own erection poking through his pants.

She'd deal with that part later. They would, together. She had no worry that it would be anything unpleasant.

Now all she wanted was to feel that cock seated up inside her and disgorging.

Phil pressed himself deeper into the couch pillows as Obinna let go of Lydia's face and slowly walked around the couch.

Ellen smiled and slipped off the couch. Mirroring Obinna's movement, she moved around the couch and knelt down in front of Lydia so their faces were level. She leaned in and her tongue flicked out against Lydia's lips.

"So what do you think of that, Mr. Ackerman, huh?" Obinna asked.

Hearing the large man say his name while he put a massive black hand on Lydia's reddened ass was jarring. Phil blinked a few times and shook his head, unable to think of a single thing to say.

His eyes were on that huge dark monster. That absolute unit of a fucking cock that was glistening and erect and poised at the mouth of Lydia's gushing pussy.

"You looking a little stunned over there, you alright?" Obinna asked. He chuckled and gave Lydia's ass cheek a jiggle.

Phil couldn't tear his gaze away from the sight of Lydia's soaked pussy. He'd never seen or felt it that wet before. The squirt Obinna had induced was only partially responsible for the state of her humectation.

Ellen's fingers bore some responsibility for it, too.

What he had seen with his own eyes, though, could not be denied. The longer she had sucked Obinna's cock, the wetter it had made her. He had watched the translucent juices come first dribbling, then running from her engorged and overstimulated vagina.

She had enjoyed sucking that cock to the point of maximal lubrication. Her body generating those precious fluids to ease the passage of Obinna's

appendage into itself.

The act of sucking had bypassed all of her higher order reasoning and appealed directly to the stem of her brain. Opening and wetting her flower to full succulence in preparation for being penetrated.

"What do you think of your wife wanting to be a good black cock slut?" Obinna demanded.

He gripped his hard cock, slick with Lydia's saliva, and drew the head along the rippled lines of her messy entrance.

"Tell us what you think?"

Ellen giggled and pulled away from the kiss she was still sharing with Lydia. "Stop teasing him!" she said, laughing before kissing Lydia on the neck.

Lydia shuddered as Obinna drew his cock against her sex again.

"I'm not teasing," Obinna said, chuckling. "A man ought to have a say in these things, don't you think? Would you like your wife to be a good black cock slut, Mr. Ackerman?" he asked.

The question placed the full weight of what was happening on Phil's shoulders. Answering would render him a full accomplice in the depravity unfolding before his eyes.

Heat surged through him. "Yes," he whispered.

Obinna chuckled and shook his head. "Not enough. You know that," he said. He moved his cock gently side to side, opening the petals of Lydia's flower wider.

Phil knew it would be arousing to say it but it still scared him. "I want my wife to be a good black cock slut." A shudder raced through him at hearing himself say it.

Lydia gasped and turned her head to look into his eyes.

That drew Ellen's attention to him, too. Her eyes narrowed, she smiled and crooked a finger, beckoning him closer to the three of them.

He hesitated. It was surreal enough being in such close proximity to Lydia's defiling. Would moving closer to it make it awkward?

Ellen stood up and moved around the back of the couch, leaning over him to whisper in his ear. "You're going to love this," she said.

She took his arm and pulled until he moved. Shifting on the couch, around the bend until he was seated right next to Lydia's naked body.

Ellen took Lydia's hand and put it in his and closed his around it. "This way you get to know what her body feels like when he goes in," she said.

Obinna put his hands on Lydia's ass cheeks and pulled them apart with his thumbs. He shuffled forward and rocked his hips slightly.

Lydia stiffened as the head of his cock slipped into her pussy with an obscene squelch. Her face turned redder in embarrassment at the sound her body had just made.

Her mouth fell open and she squeezed Phil's hand hard. "Oh my gaaaawd," she moaned as Obinna began to fill her wet cavity with his shaft.

Obinna drew in a slow breath and pulled on her hips, pulling her body onto his cock. Every few inches he paused, letting her moan and adjust to his formidable size.

Lydia would let out a few rapid breaths when he stilled, a sound she might make getting into a lake that was too cold.

When her breath had normalized, Obinna would continue. Pulling on her and pressing deeper into her insides until just a few inches of his cock remained exposed.

"That's...that's all I can take," Lydia gasped, her voice strained and breathless.

Obinna's hands stilled on her hips. He didn't move, didn't thrust deeper, just held himself inside her. "You think so?"

"I'm serious. You're too...you're too big."

"Your body doesn't agree with you," Obinna said, his voice patient and measured. "You feel that? How wet you are? How your pussy is gripping me?"

Lydia whimpered.

"This is like riding, Lydia. You don't learn fucking by being taught. You learn it by doing. By understanding what your body can handle. What it wants." His thumbs traced slow circles on her ass cheeks. "Right now your mind is scared, but your body? Your body knows what it needs."

Phil watched Lydia's face transform, her eyes glazing over as she processed Obinna's words.

"You need training. Patience. Time to discover what you're capable of." Obinna's voice dropped lower, almost hypnotic. "Trust me to show you."

Without warning, he gave one final lazy thrust.

Lydia's entire body went rigid. Her mouth opened in a silent moan as the thickest part of his cock stretched her pussy opening.

"Holy fucking...oh my god, oh my GOD!" The words tumbled out of her in a rush. "That feels so fucking good. Jesus Christ, that feels so fucking good!"

Her hips started moving on their own, bucking back and forth in small, desperate motions.

Phil stared at her, aghast at seeing her in this state. Utterly in the thrall of Obinna's enormous prick inside her.

"Please," she begged. "Please fuck me. Obinna, please, I need..."

He didn't move. Didn't give her what she wanted. He just held himself deep inside her, letting her feel every thick inch of his cock.

Then his hand cracked across her ass.

The sharp smack echoed through the room and Lydia yelped. Her body arched up instinctively, then came down hard, taking the full length of him in one smooth motion.

"Oh fuck!" she cried out.

Obinna smacked her again, same spot, same force.

Lydia's body repeated the motion. Arching up, coming down, fucking herself onto his cock.

Again. Another smack.

Again, her body responded.

Lydia released Phil's hand and grabbed the backrest of the couch with both hands, white-knuckled and shaking.

Smack. Smack. Smack.

Each blow sent her hips rolling in a fluid rhythm Phil had never witnessed before. Her back curved in an elegant arch, her ass lifting and falling in a mesmerizing dance.

She wasn't just taking Obinna's cock anymore. She was riding it. Working it with her entire body in a way that looked like she'd been a practised stripper for years.

"That's it," Obinna encouraged. "Feel how your body moves. Feel what it can do."

Lydia moaned long and low, her hips gyrating in circles now, not just up and down but side to side, grinding herself against him.

Phil stared, transfixed. This wasn't the careful, controlled woman he'd made love to for twenty-three years. This was someone else entirely.

Someone uninhibited and utterly lost in sensation.

Ellen moved beside Phil, her hand resting on his thigh. "Isn't she beautiful?" she whispered.

Obinna's hands returned to Lydia's hips, guiding her movements, slowing her down when she got frantic, speeding her up when she grew timid.

Training her. Teaching her body what it could handle and what it wanted.

Lydia's moans grew louder, more desperate, her rhythm becoming more confident with each roll of her hips.

Soon Obinna took his hands off of her hips and simply stood there, his cock jutting out for her use.

She continued the motion, hips rolling, ass rising and falling, moaning with her breasts smacking each other as she rode towards an orgasm.

The fluids leaking from where Obinna's cock stretched Lydia's pussy had changed. What had started as clear, viscous arousal now frothed white and creamy around his dark shaft. The substance built up at the base where their bodies met, creating a thick ring that spread with each impact of her ass against his abdomen.

Lydia rode harder now, completely lost to the sensation. Her movements had become almost violent in their intensity, her ass cheeks bouncing and jiggling as they slammed back into Obinna's pelvis with meaty thwacks that filled the room.

The wet sounds coming from between her legs grew louder and more obscene but now she didn't seem to care. Each time she lifted and dropped, Phil could hear the squelch and suction of her pussy gripping and releasing Obinna's cock. A frothy mixture coated her inner thighs, dripping down in long strings.

Her breasts swayed wildly, slapping together with each desperate thrust of her hips. Sweat beaded on her back, her skin flushed pink from exertion and arousal.

"Oh fuck, oh fuck, oh FUCK!" she chanted, her voice rising in pitch.

Her hand shot out blindly, searching. Phil caught it and she squeezed down hard enough to make his bones ache.

"I'm going to...I can't..."

The shriek that tore from her throat wasn't human.

Her body went rigid. Phil felt the tremor run through her from where their hands connected, watched her back arch impossibly far, saw her thighs begin to shake uncontrollably.

The wet squishing between her legs intensified as her pussy began to contract around Obinna's cock in rapid pulses. More fluid gushed out around his shaft, adding to the frothy mess coating both their bodies.

"Oh god, oh god, oh god!" Each word came out strangled and breathless.

Wave after wave crashed through her. Phil could see it in how her muscles tensed and released, how her fingers spasmed around his hand, how her mouth hung open before another moan tore free.

Her hips kept moving on their own, grinding in small circles as if trying to wring every last drop of pleasure from the orgasm wracking her body.

"Please, please, please," she whimpered, though Phil had no idea what she was begging for.

The contractions slowed but didn't stop. Her thighs trembled violently now, barely able to support her weight. Another shudder ran through her, another gasp tore from her throat.

Finally, after what felt like minutes but could only have been seconds, Lydia collapsed forward over the backrest of the couch. Her weight pressed

against the furniture, her breasts squashed flat against the upholstery.

She panted like she'd run a marathon, great heaving breaths that shook her entire frame. Sweat dripped from her forehead onto the fabric below. Her legs twitched with aftershocks, small tremors that rippled through her muscles.

Obinna remained buried inside her, his hands now resting gently on her lower back. He didn't move, didn't thrust, just let her recover while staying deeply seated.

Phil stared at his wife's face. Her eyes were closed, her expression one of complete and utter satisfaction. A small smile played at the corners of her mouth despite her obvious exhaustion.

Lydia's hand still gripped his, though the pressure had eased. Her fingers twitched occasionally as the last waves of pleasure ebbed away.

Obinna's hands settled on Lydia's hips with a possessiveness that made Phil's stomach clench.

He began to move. Slow, deliberate strokes that pulled his gleaming cock halfway out before pushing back in. The creamy white ring around his shaft stretched and compressed with each thrust, a visual reminder of what Lydia's body had done to him.

Lydia's eyes flew open. A small whimper escaped her throat.

"Can't," she gasped. "Too sensitive. I can't..."

"Shh." Obinna's thumbs traced circles on her hip bones. "Just feel it."

His pace remained unhurried. Back and forth, a hypnotic rhythm that made Lydia's whole body twitch with each pass. Her fingers tightened around Phil's hand again, not in pain but in overwhelmed sensation.

Phil watched the thick black shaft disappear into his wife's pussy and emerge glistening with her arousal. The contrast of their skin tones

mesmerized him. Obinna's dark cock vanishing into Lydia's pale flesh, stretching her open, claiming territory Phil had thought was his alone.

His free hand moved to his crotch without conscious thought. He pressed against the bulge straining his jeans, trying to ease the ache building there.

This was it. The moment he'd been half-dreading, half-anticipating since they'd walked through Obinna's door.

Genetic material. The phrase lodged in his brain and wouldn't dislodge. That's what was about to happen. Another man's seed, pumped deep into Lydia's womb. Millions of swimmers racing toward her egg, trying to do what nature had designed them to do.

Such an intimate exchange. More intimate than the fucking itself, somehow. The fluids mingling, Obinna's essence coating Lydia's insides, marking her from within.

Phil rubbed harder through the denim. His cock throbbed, already leaking pre-cum into his boxer briefs.

Obinna's breathing changed. Grew heavier. His thrusts quickened just slightly, losing that measured control.

"Fuck," he muttered. "This pussy..."

Lydia moaned in response, her hips starting to move with him again despite her claims of being too sensitive.

Phil's hand worked faster. He couldn't stop himself. He couldn't tear his eyes away from where their bodies joined. From the frothy mess coating Obinna's shaft. From the way Lydia's pussy lips stretched obscenely around him.

Obinna's fingers dug into Lydia's hips. His abs tensed.

This was it.

Phil's own orgasm built rapidly, spiraling up from his balls. He was going to come watching another man ejaculate into his wife. Going to climax at the exact moment Obinna filled her with...

Obinna pulled out.

His cock gleamed in the lamplight for half a second before thick ropes of semen erupted from the tip. White against Lydia's pale back, spattering across her ass cheeks, painting her skin in long streaks.

"Oh fuck!" Obinna groaned, his hand working his shaft, milking out spurt after spurt.

Phil's orgasm hit him at the same time. His pelvic floor contracted and he felt the gush of his load spew impotently into his underwear.

His vision blurred. His hips jerked involuntarily. Hot wetness flooded his underwear as his cock pulsed again and again inside his jeans, coating the fabric with his release.

A blinding, blurring ecstasy swirled inside him momentarily, and then began to evaporate like his own sweat as he stared at the scene before him.

Dear God, his own voice clanged like cold metal in the confines of his skull. *What have I done?*

END PART I

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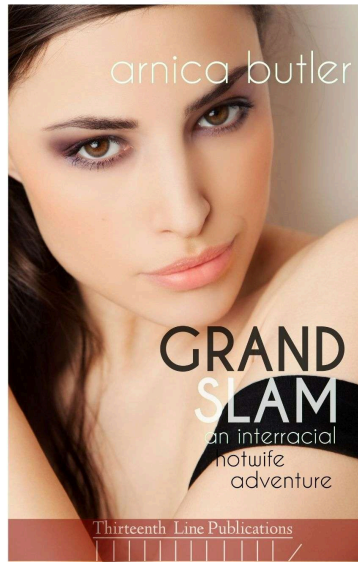
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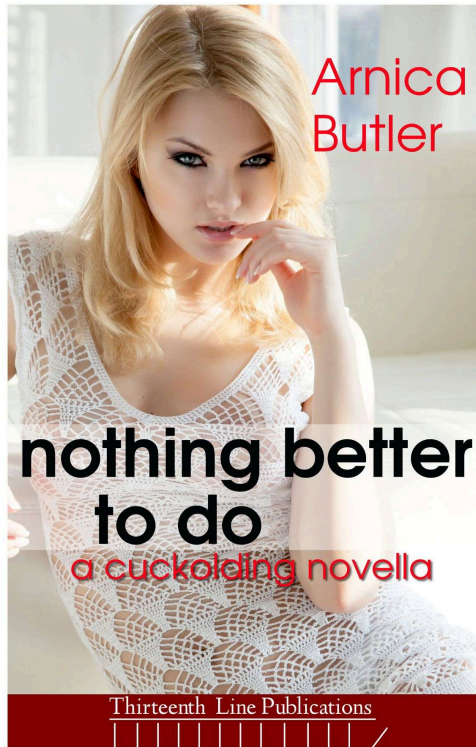
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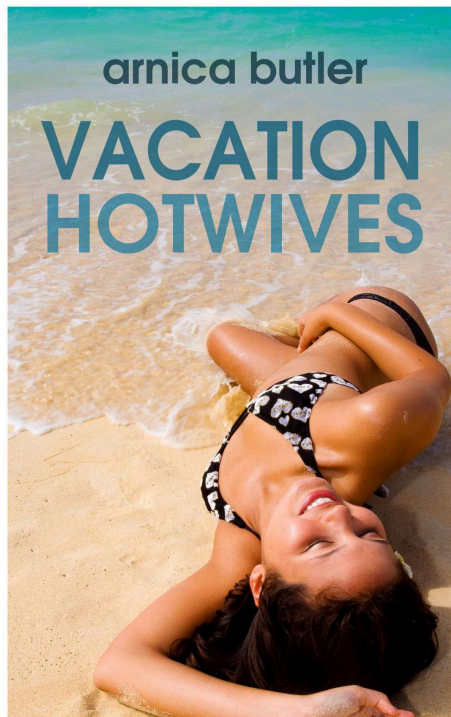
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